



COURSE SLIDES · NON-WSQ

Achieving Sales Goals with Customer-Centric Selling Techniques

Course Code: C1088

Trainer: Dr. Alfred Ang

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COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome & Housekeeping

About the Trainer



Your Trainer

General Trainer template —
to be completed by the trainer

NAME

TITLE / DESIGNATION

QUALIFICATIONS

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

TRAINING & INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

CONTACT

About the Trainer



Dr. Alfred Ang

Principal Trainer
Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte. Ltd.

ROLE

Principal Trainer, Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte. Ltd.

CERTIFICATION / CREDENTIALS

20+ years of training and sales-industry experience.

DELIVERS

Courses on consultative selling, sales closing techniques and empathy-driven customer communication.

FOUNDER

Founder and lead instructor at Tertiary Infotech / Tertiary Courses.

ICE-BREAKER

Let's Know Each Other

1

Your name and organisation / role.

2

Your experience with sales, closing or customer-facing conversations (if any).

3

A salesperson (or a sale) that genuinely won you over — and why it worked.

Ground Rules

1

Set your mobile phone to silent mode.

2

Actively participate — no question is too small.

3

Respect each other's views: agree to disagree.

4

One conversation at a time.

5

Be punctual; return from breaks on time.

6

Full attendance — attend both days to get the most from the course.

Course Outline

1

LU1 — Foundations of Selling

Mindset · Empathy · Sales Strategy · Buyer Psychology · Discovery

2

LU2 — Selling Techniques & Problem-Solving

Problem-Based Selling · Demos · Upselling & Cross-Selling · Personalisation · Champions

3

LU3 — Closing the Sale

Buying Signals · Closing Techniques · Justifying Price · Easy to Buy · Follow-Up

4

LU4 — Handling Objections & Rejections

Objection vs Deflection vs Rejection · Answer & Ask · Composure · Testimonials · Metrics

SCHEDULE

Lesson Plan — 2 Days

Day 1

- Day 1 — Foundations of Selling & Selling Techniques and Problem-Solving
 - LU1: Foundations of Selling + Role Play (09:35–13:55)
 - LU2: Selling Techniques & Problem-Solving + Role Play (13:55–17:25)
 - Day 1 recap and close (17:25–17:30)

Day 2

- Day 2 — Closing the Sale and Handling Objections & Rejections
 - LU3: Closing the Sale + Role Play (09:35–14:00)
 - LU4: Handling Objections & Rejections + Role Play, Course Feedback (14:00–17:30)
- Daily timing
 - Both days run 9:30am–5:30pm: 7.5 instructional hours plus a 30-minute lunch.

LU1

Foundations of Selling

Mindset · Empathy · Sales Strategy · Buyer Psychology · Discovery

Key Concepts — Foundations of Selling

1

Selling is a human, empathy-driven conversation — mindset shapes the outcome before any technique does.

2

Empathy is a trainable skill, not a personality trait: see their world, suspend judgement, and name the emotion out loud (affect labelling).

3

A sales strategy starts with the math of sales — leads to conversations to proposals to closes — and a written goal for every call.

4

Buyer psychology (Cialdini's principles, the buyer's matrix, the illusion of choice) shapes how a prospect actually decides.

5

Discovery uses Bucket, Why-Why-Why, SPIN and Gap questions, always with permission, to uncover the real need before recommending anything.

Cialdini's 7 Principles of Persuasion

Robert Cialdini identified seven levers that drive human decisions. Ground every discovery call and close in these — and never use them to manipulate.



Reciprocity

Give genuine value before asking for anything.



Commitment

Small agreed steps make a bigger yes feel safe.



Social Proof

People follow similar others when uncertain.



Authority

Credible expertise, shown rather than claimed.



Liking

Genuine rapport makes agreement feel easier.



Scarcity

Real, honest limits only — never fabricate one.



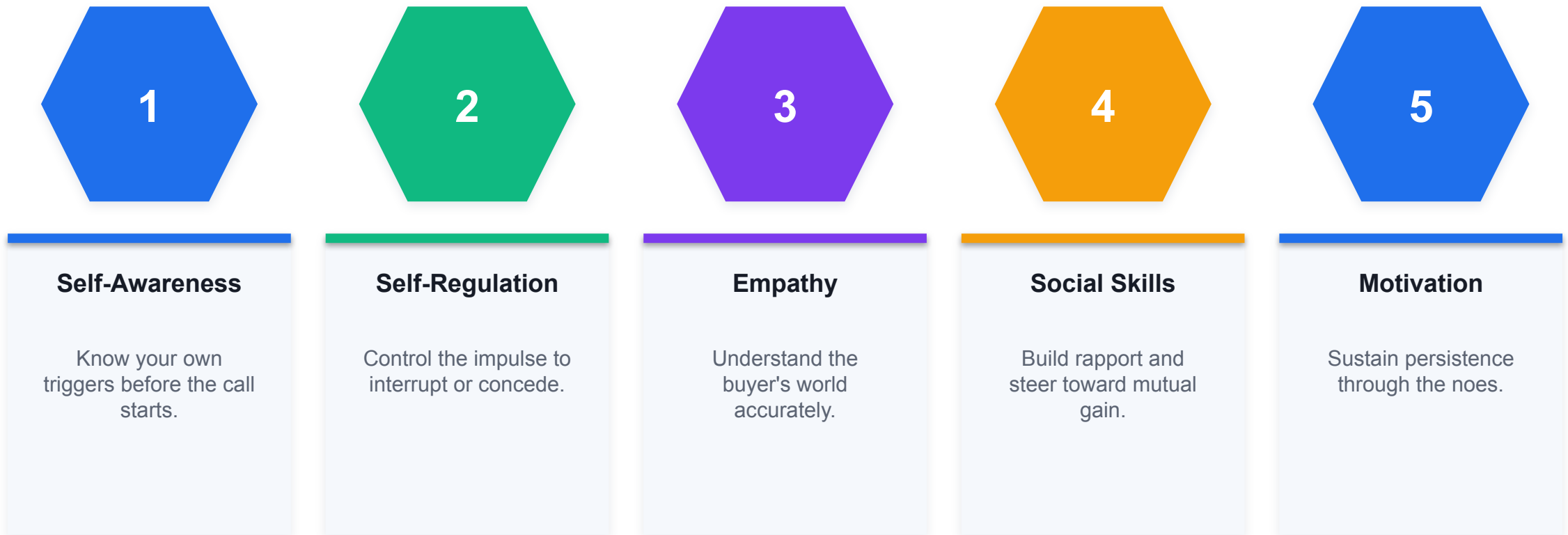
Unity (2016)

A shared identity beats surface-level liking.

Source: Cialdini, R. — Influence (1984); Pre-Suasion (2016)

The Five Competencies of Emotional Intelligence in Sales

Technical skill gets you the meeting. These five decide whether you leave it with a deal.



Source: Goleman-style EI competencies applied to selling (Paperflite; EI-in-sales literature)

SPIN Selling — The Largest Study of Sales Behaviour Ever Run

Neil Rackham's Huthwaite team observed real sales calls to find what top performers actually do differently.

35,000+

Sales calls observed in the Huthwaite research programme

12 yrs

Duration of the study behind SPIN Selling (published 1988)

4

Question types — Situation, Problem, Implication, Need-Payoff

The core finding: top performers ask more Implication and Need-Payoff questions — they get the BUYER to state the value, rather than claiming it themselves.

LO1 · LU1 · T1

the Selling Mindset

What is the Selling Mindset?

Before a single technique matters, the buyer is reading who you are. Mindset is not a warm-up — it is the first thing you sell.



Sell Like a Human

Talk to a person solving a problem, not a quota to close.



Want It Genuinely

Real desire to help the buyer win is what sustains persistence.



Confidence From Prep

Confidence comes from preparation, not from volume or bravado.

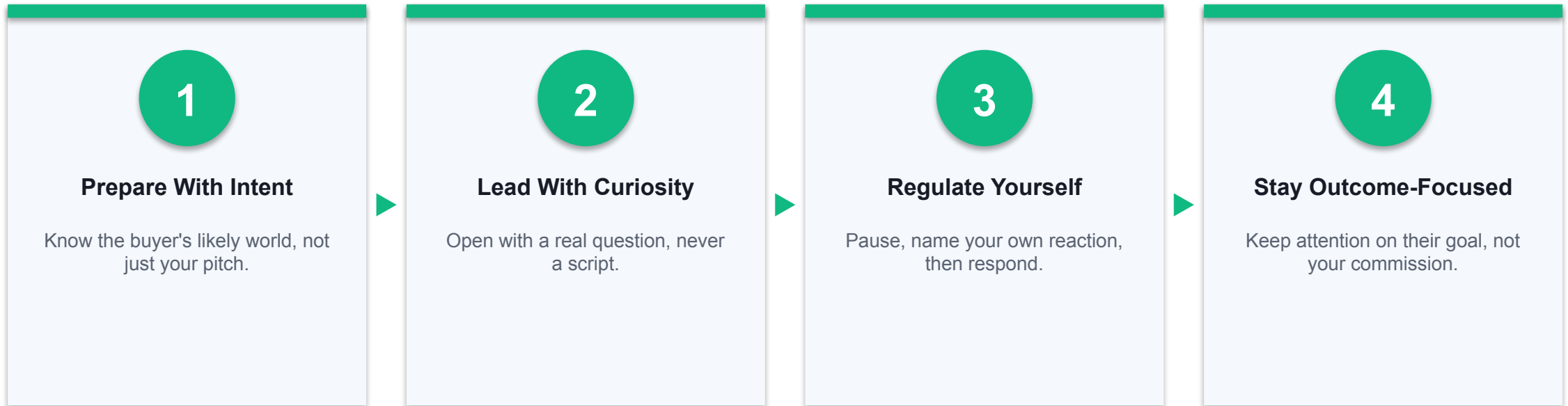


Reduce the Fear

A 'no' is information about fit — never a verdict on your worth.

Source: sales-mindset coaching practice; emotional-intelligence components (self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation)

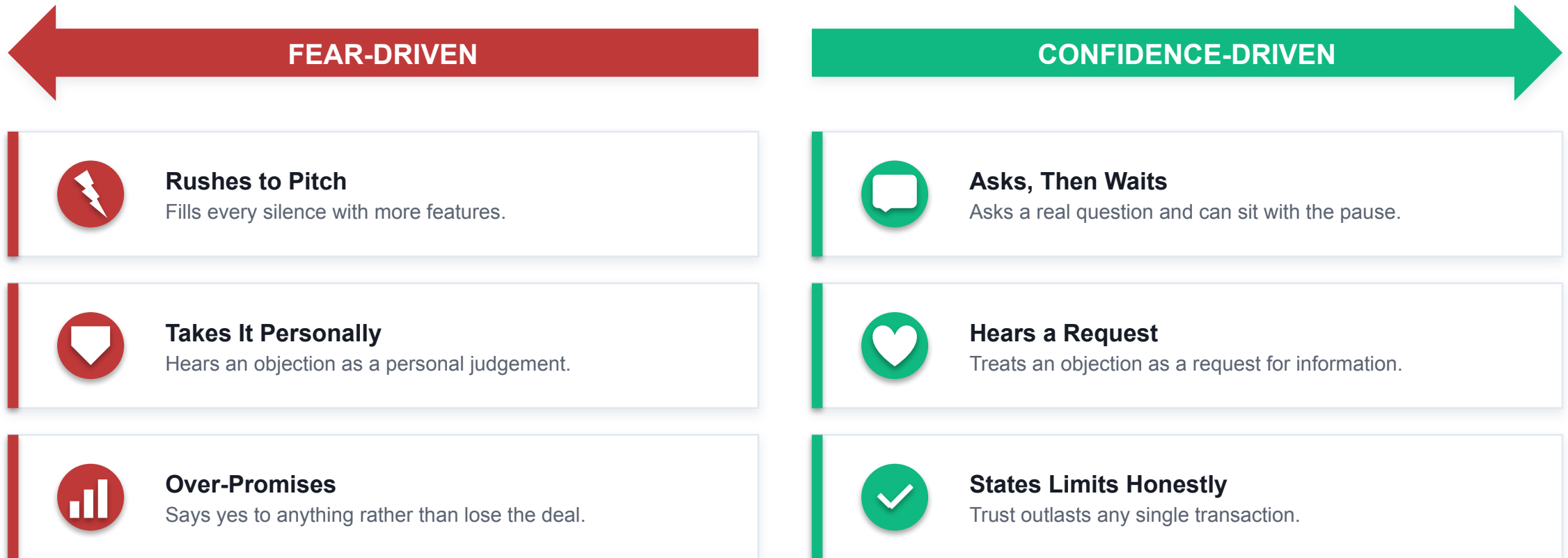
How Mindset Shapes the Call



Self-regulation is the skill: the pause between what you feel and what you say is where the deal is protected.

Source: sales-mindset coaching practice; EI self-regulation research

Fear-Driven vs Confidence-Driven Selling



Source: sales-mindset coaching practice

Why Mindset Comes First

The numbers behind 'people buy from people' — treat these as directional, not precise.

70%

Buy on feeling

- of customers buy based on how they feel about the seller

+50%

High-EQ advantage

- ▲ reported outperformance of high-EQ sellers vs peers

93%

Non-verbal

- commonly-cited share of meaning carried beyond the words

Directional figures, widely cited in sales-EI literature — use them to make the point, not as precise benchmarks.

Source: emotional-intelligence-in-sales literature (Cerde Dubó, LinkedIn, 2025; Paperflite) — commonly-cited industry figures

T2

LO1 · LU1 · T2

Empathy in Selling

What is Empathy in Selling?

Empathy is not being nice. It is the disciplined skill of understanding the buyer's world accurately enough to be genuinely useful in it.



See Their World

Take the buyer's perspective as they actually experience it.



Stay Non-Judgemental

Drop the verdict on whether their concern is reasonable.



Separate Your Feelings

Recognise your own reaction as yours, not theirs.

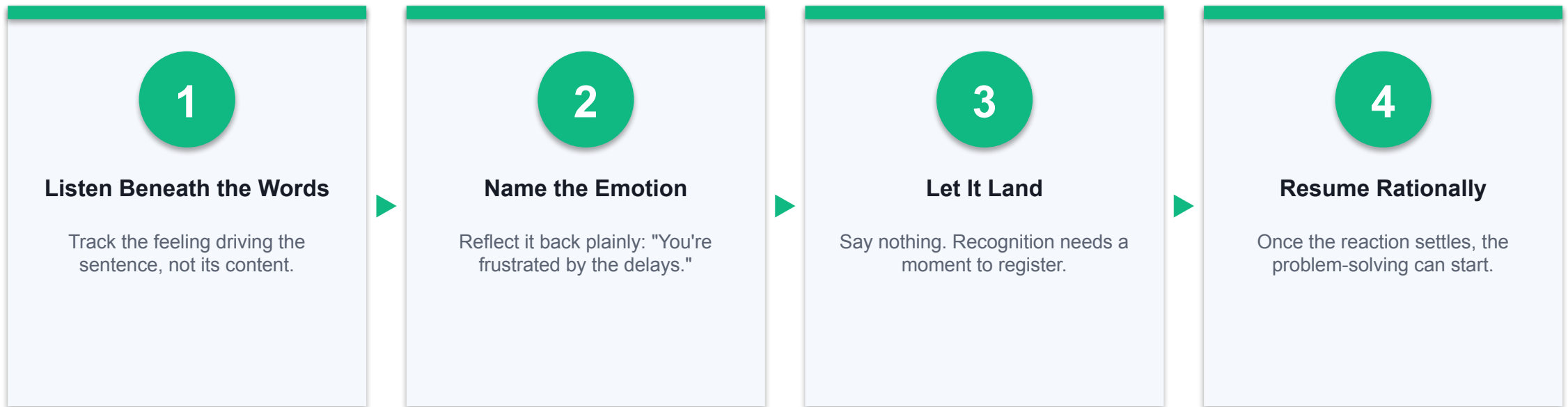


Prioritise Their Story

Their account of the problem outranks your pitch.

Source: Brené Brown's four attributes of empathy, applied to selling (via empathy-driven sales-closing practice)

Affect Labelling — Noll's 'Listen to the Emotions'



Affect labelling dampens the brain's reactive centres — Doug Noll reports it can restore rational dialogue in under 90 seconds.

Source: Doug Noll, affect labelling / the 90-Second Power Move; neuroscience of emotion labelling and amygdala reactivity

Sympathy vs Empathy — Only One of Them Sells

S

Sympathy

- "I'm sorry you're dealing with that."
- Feels AT the buyer, from a distance.
- Closes the topic and moves on to the pitch.
- Leaves the buyer still holding the problem alone.

E

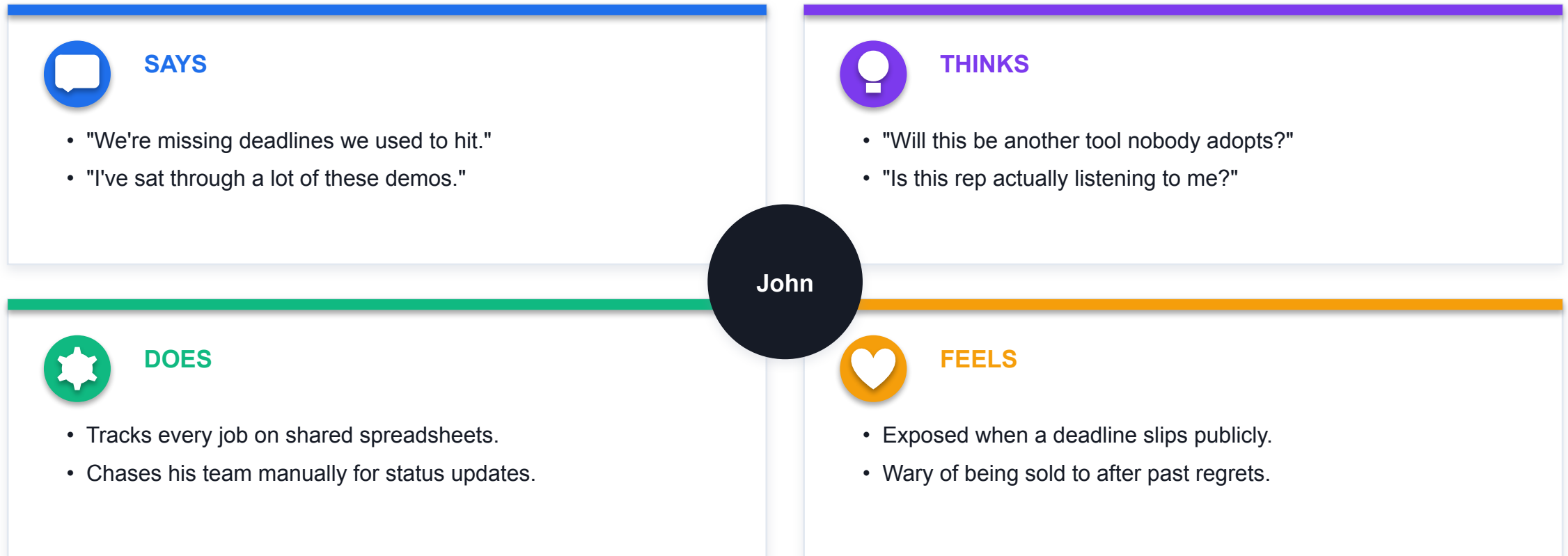
Empathy

- "So the deadline slipped and you took the heat."
- Feels WITH the buyer, from beside them.
- Opens the topic so the real need can surface.
- Makes the buyer feel accurately understood.

Source: empathy-in-sales practice; Brené Brown on empathy vs sympathy

Empathy Map — John, the Buyer You'll Meet in the Role Play

Build this map BEFORE you build the pitch. Everything in the role play later today comes from reading this correctly.



Source: empathy-mapping practice, grounded in this course's role-play persona

The First Formal 'Ask Before You Pitch' Sales Method

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Xerox

Xerox's Professional Selling Skills (PSS) programme, developed in the 1960s-70s, was among the first to formalise buyer-centred questioning over a hard pitch — the direct ancestor of the discovery-led, empathy-aware selling taught in this course.

T3

LO1 · LU1 · T3

a Sales Strategy

What is a Sales Strategy?

Hope is not a strategy. Know your numbers, and you know exactly which part of your selling to fix.



The Math of Sales

Every sale is a chain of ratios —
know yours by heart.



Written Call Goals

One specific, stated aim per call
beats 'try to sell'.



Find the Bottleneck

Fix the weakest ratio, not the
loudest complaint.



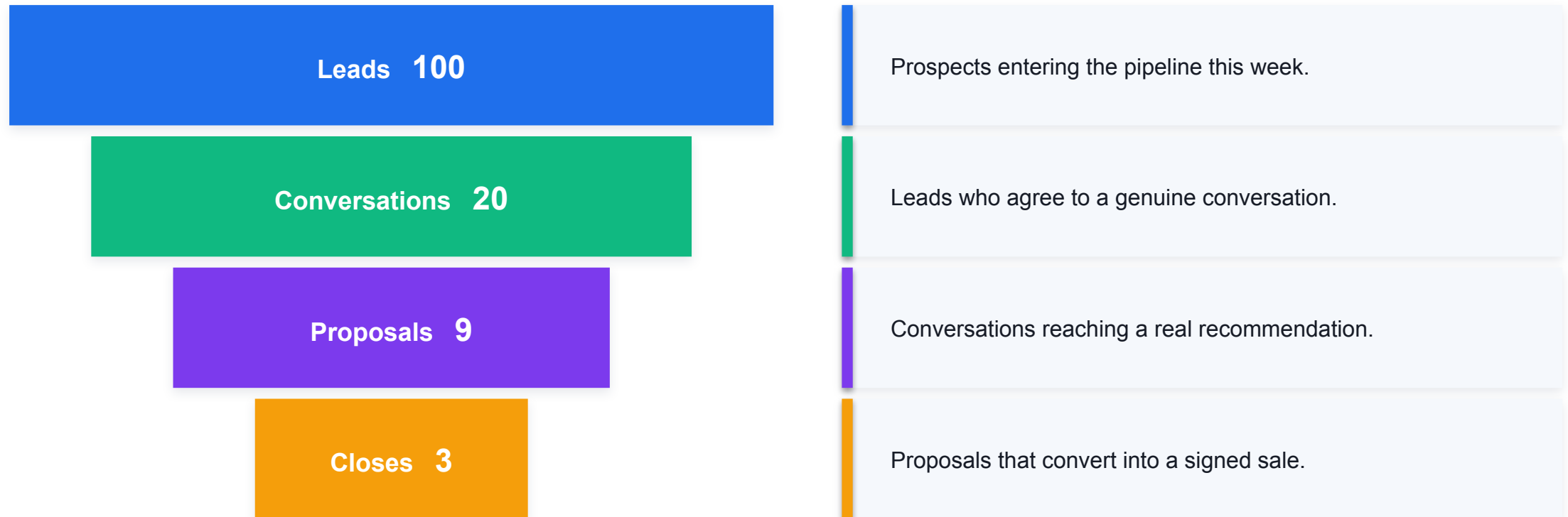
Protect the Pipeline

Today's prospecting is next
quarter's commission.

Source: sales-pipeline management practice

The Math of Sales — Where Deals Actually Leak

Illustrative weekly pipeline. The ratio between two stages tells you precisely which skill to work on next.



A weak leads-to-conversations ratio is a prospecting problem. A weak proposals-to-closes ratio is a closing problem. Different fix entirely.

Source: illustrative sales-funnel ratios, pipeline-management synthesis

Vague Activity vs Goal-Driven Activity

Vague Activity

- "I'll make some calls today."
- No idea which ratio in the chain is actually weak.
- Success is whatever happens to land.
- Busy all week, no idea if it worked.

Goal-Driven Activity

- "I will book 5 discovery calls from 20 dials today."
- Tracks each stage to find the real bottleneck.
- Success is a stated, specific, checkable target.
- Knows by Friday exactly what to change on Monday.

Source: sales-goal-setting practice

What the Industry Data Says About Closing

Three numbers worth pinning above your desk.

29%

Average close rate

- reported across industries — the bar is lower than you fear

48%

Calls with no close

- ▼ of sales calls end without the seller ever asking

5-12

Contacts needed

- ▲ 80% of sales close only after this many touches

Nearly half of all calls end without anyone asking for the business. Simply asking, properly, is a measurable edge.

Source: sales-benchmark synthesis (alexberman.com; Lusha via monday.com) — industry-reported figures

LO1 · LU1 · T4

Buyer Psychology

What is Buyer Psychology?

People buy emotionally and justify logically. Your job is to earn the feeling honestly, then arm the justification.



Why People Really Buy

To solve a felt problem — logic arrives afterwards to justify it.



The Power of Words

Concrete language outsells vague claims every time.



The Illusion of Choice

Two good options feel empowering; one feels like pressure.

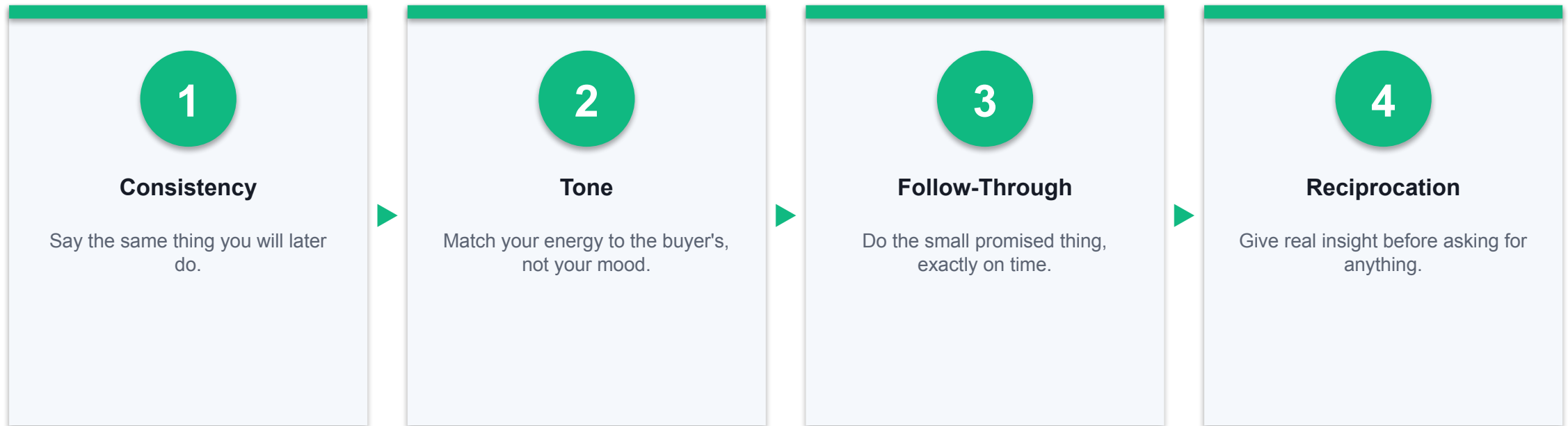


Trust Beats Charm

Consistency and follow-through, not personality, build trust.

Source: buyer-psychology and persuasion research

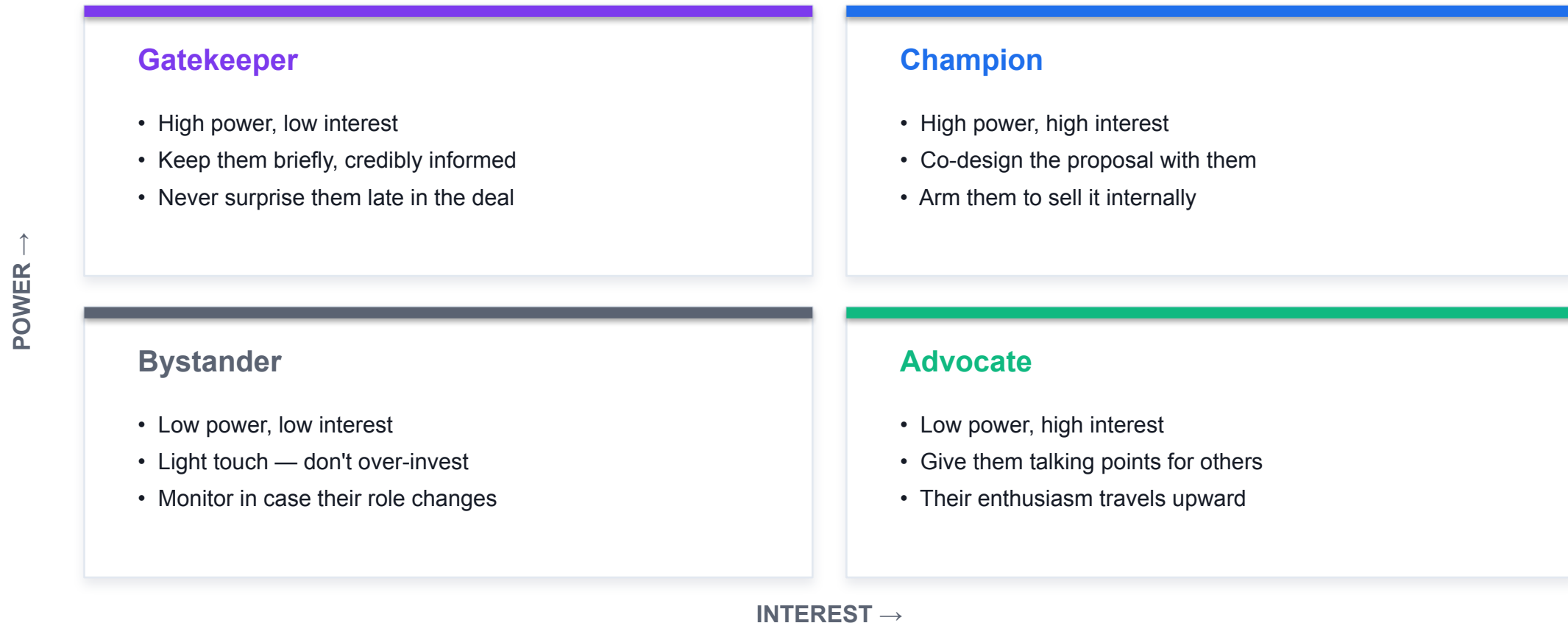
How Trust Is Actually Built During a Call



Source: trust-and- rapport building practice

The Buyer's Matrix — Map Every Stakeholder Before You Pitch

Power on the vertical, interest on the horizontal. Each quadrant needs a completely different investment of your time.



Source: stakeholder power-interest mapping, adapted for buyer psychology

Cialdini's Principles at Work in a Sales Call

Seven levers of influence — every one of them is a way to be genuinely useful, and every one can be abused. Use them honestly.



Reciprocity

Give real value before you ask for anything.



Commitment

Small agreed steps make the big yes feel safe.



Social Proof

Show what similar buyers chose, and why.



Authority

Demonstrate expertise; never merely claim it.



Liking

Genuine rapport makes agreement easier.



Scarcity

State real limits only — never fabricate one.



Unity

A shared identity or goal beats surface liking.

Source: Cialdini, R. — Influence (1984); Pre-Suasion (2016, adds Unity)

T5

LO1 · LU1 · T5

the Discovery Process

What is the Discovery Process?

The best closers are the best listeners. Discovery is where the sale is actually won — the close is just the paperwork.



The Point of Discovery

Uncover the real need before recommending anything.



Bucket Questions

Broad openers that let the buyer pick what matters.



Why, Why, Why

Repeated whys dig from symptom to the felt problem.



Permission-Based Selling

Ask before you probe — consent keeps them in control.

Source: SPIN Selling discovery practice, adapted for course use

SPIN Selling — Rackham's Question Sequence

Four question types, always in this order. Skip a stage and the buyer never says the sentence that sells them.



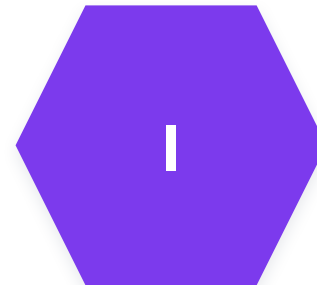
Situation

What does the current process actually look like?



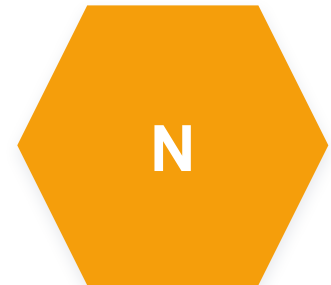
Problem

Where specifically is it breaking down?



Implication

What is that difficulty really costing?



Need-Payoff

What would solving it be worth to you?

Source: Rackham, N. — SPIN Selling (1988); Huthwaite research across 35,000+ sales calls

Closed Questions vs Gap Questions

Closed Questions

- "Are you happy with your current system?"
- Invites a one-word answer that ends the conversation.
- Reveals almost nothing about the real gap.
- You leave the call still guessing.

Gap Questions

- "What would it mean if you solved this for good?"
- Invites the buyer to describe the gap in their own words.
- Surfaces the implication they hadn't said out loud.
- They talk themselves toward the decision.

Source: Gap-question technique, discovery-conversation practice

Bucket Questions — Let the Buyer Choose the Topic

Open wide, then follow whichever door they walk through.



People

"How is your team handling the workload now?"



Process

"Walk me through how a job gets tracked today."



Technology

"What tools are you relying on, and where do they fall short?"



Priorities

"What would make the biggest difference this quarter?"

Source: Bucket-question discovery technique

Role Play: Foundations of Selling

ROLE PLAY

THE SITUATION

Jessica is a sales rep for CloudFlow, a cloud-based project-management platform. John is a project manager at Sunrise Builders, a mid-sized construction firm in Singapore, where every job is tracked on shared spreadsheets. Since the team grew from 8 to 19, two handover deadlines have slipped because updates never reached the right person — and John's director asked him about it in front of the team.

This is Jessica's first real conversation with John. Her goal for the call is NOT to sell software: it is to earn enough trust to run a genuine discovery conversation. John has sat through several demos before, bought a tool two years ago that nobody adopted, and is quietly testing whether this rep is any different.

The scene runs from the opening minute — mindset, rapport, permission to ask — through discovery using Why-Why-Why and Gap questions, into a solution shaped by what John actually said, addressing his fear of another failed rollout, and closing on one concrete next step.

You'll produce: A completed Role-Play Observer Scorecard citing specific lines for mindset, a Gap Question, affect labelling, a principle of influence, and a buying signal

Duration: 1 hour

Role Play: Foundations of Selling

ASSIGN THE ROLES

Jessica — Sales Rep, CloudFlow

GOAL

Earn trust and uncover John's real project-tracking pain before proposing anything

Trained to lead with permission-based discovery, not a features list. She must resist pitching for the first five minutes, however tempting John's opening complaint makes it.

John — Project Manager, Sunrise Builders

GOAL

Decide whether this rep genuinely understands construction chaos, or is just selling

Burned by a tool his team never adopted. He will open with a surface complaint ('we just need better reminders') that is NOT the real problem — the real problem is that he is personally accountable for information he cannot see.

Observer / Coach

GOAL

Score the conversation against the Foundations checklist and give usable feedback

Watches for mindset language, affect labelling, genuine Gap questions, named principles of influence, and the moment hesitation turns into a buying signal. Quotes exact lines in the debrief — never general impressions.

Role Play: Foundations of Selling

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

- 1 Where did Jessica's mindset actually show up in her word choice — and where did it slip into pitching?
- 2 Which questions were genuine Gap Questions, and which were closed questions dressed up as open ones?
- 3 Did Jessica ever name John's emotion out loud (affect labelling)? What changed in the conversation right after — or what was missed by skipping it?
- 4 Which of Cialdini's principles did Jessica use, deliberately or not — and did it land as genuinely helpful or as manipulation?
- 5 At what exact line did John's hesitation become a buying signal rather than a polite brush-off?
- 6 John's stated problem was 'better reminders'. What was the real problem underneath, and which question surfaced it?

Role Play: Foundations of Selling

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- What surprised you about how quickly trust built once Jessica asked permission to ask questions?
- Did the two-option close (pilot vs full rollout) feel empowering to the buyer, or like pressure in disguise?
- Which single question from the discovery phase would you steal for your own next sales call?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

The observer can quote at least one specific mindset moment, one genuine Gap Question, one attempt at naming John's emotion, one named principle of influence, and one real buying signal — with the exact line cited, not a general impression.

Recap — Foundations of Selling

1

Selling Mindset

You can now: adopt a confident, human, fear-reduced mindset before any sales conversation.

2

Empathy as a Sales Skill

You can now: apply empathy and affect labelling as a deliberate, trainable selling technique.

3

Sales Strategy

You can now: build a sales strategy from the math of sales and clear goal setting.

4

Understanding Buyer Psychology

You can now: apply Cialdini's principles of influence and the buyer's matrix to how prospects decide.

5

Discovery Process

You can now: run a permission-based discovery conversation using SPIN-style questioning.

6

Role Play: Foundations of Selling

You practised: apply mindset, empathy, buyer psychology and discovery questioning in a live sales call.

LU1 · WHY IT MATTERS

People don't buy products. They buy a better version of themselves, sold to them by someone they trust.

— Closing thought, LU1: Foundations of Selling

LU2

Selling Techniques & Problem-Solving

Problem-Based Selling · Demos · Upselling & Cross-Selling · Personalisation · Champions

Key Concepts — Selling Techniques & Problem-Solving

1

Problem-based selling and 'What Would Your Customer Say?' put the customer's own words — not the salesperson's script — at the centre of the pitch.

2

A great demo Educates (the what), Demonstrates (the how) and builds Buy-In (the why) — in that order, never skipped.

3

Upselling and cross-selling only land once the customer has realised value from what they already bought, and only when the add-on is genuinely relevant.

4

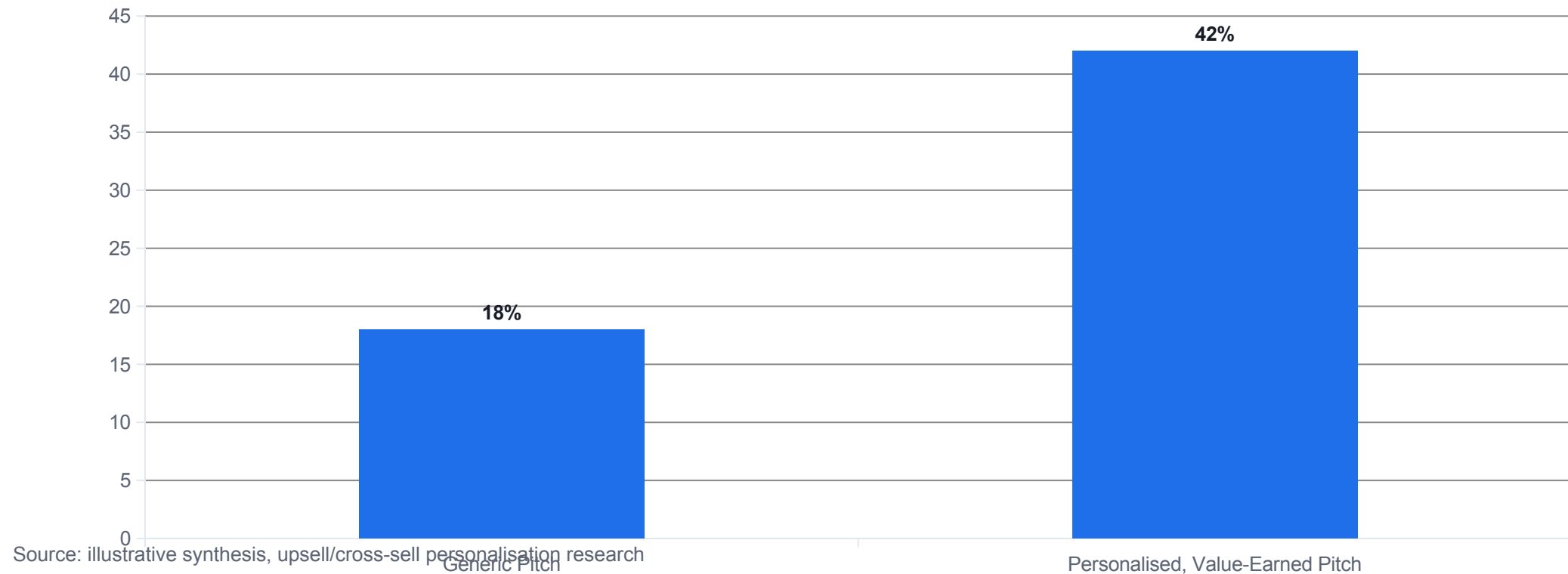
Personalisation means proving you remember what they told you — and adapting to the analytical, relationship, decisive or cautious buyer in front of you.

5

Champion Selling equips someone inside the organisation to win the argument you will never be in the room for.

Personalisation Changes Whether an Upsell Lands

Illustrative attach-rate comparison: a generic add-on pitch versus one earned and personalised to the buyer's own stated problem.



The gap isn't the product — it's whether the offer was earned and personalised before it was ever raised.

Educate → Demonstrate → Buy-In

Three moves, always in this order. Skip Educate and the demo is a features tour; skip Buy-In and nobody owns the decision.

1

Educate — The What

Frame the problem so the solution makes sense.

2

Demonstrate — The How

Show only the part that fixes their stated pain.

3

Buy-In — The Why

Let them describe using it in their own words.

The buyer describing how they'd use it is worth more than any feature you could have shown them instead.

LO2 · LU2 · T1

Problem-Based Selling

What is Problem-Based Selling?

Nobody wakes up wanting your product. They wake up wanting their problem to stop. Sell the second thing and the first takes care of itself.



Start From the Problem

Open with their difficulty, never with your feature list.



Use Their Own Words

Repeat the phrase they used — not your marketing copy.



Quantify the Cost

A problem with a number attached earns a budget.

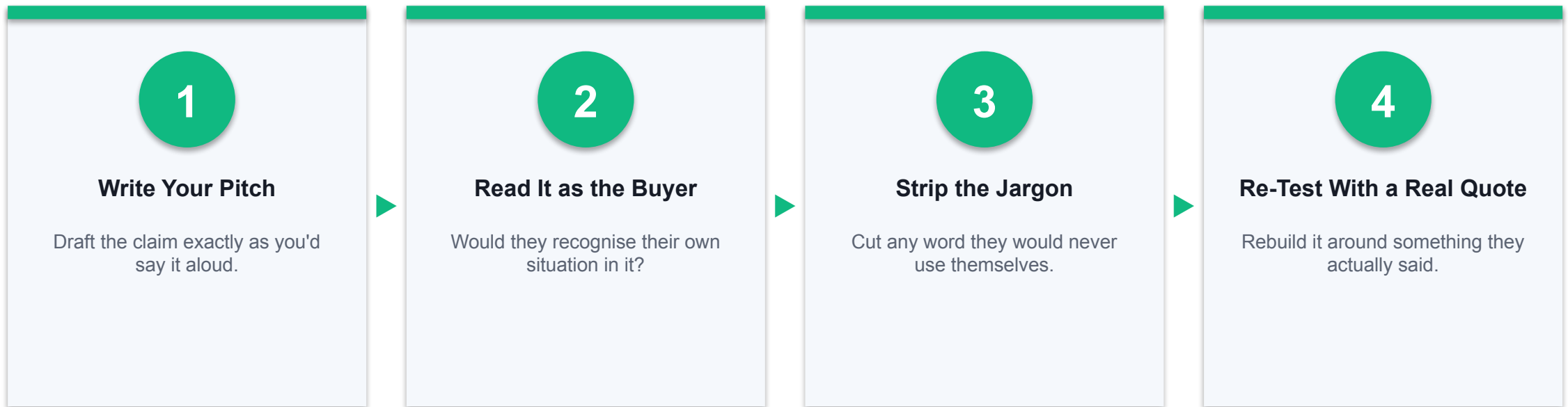


Confirm Before Solving

"Have I got that right?" before you propose anything.

Source: problem-based / consultative selling practice

The 'What Would Your Customer Say?' Test



If your buyer wouldn't say the sentence out loud, it isn't a benefit — it's marketing copy.

Source: WWYCS technique, customer-language sales practice

Feature-Led vs Problem-Led Conversations

Feature-Led

- "We offer real-time dashboards and 40+ integrations."
- Buyer must work out what any of it means for them.
- Competes on specification, so price becomes the deciding factor.
- The demo is a lecture the buyer sits through.

Problem-Led

- "You said updates get lost between site and office — here's that gap closed."
- Buyer immediately sees their own situation solved.
- Competes on outcome, so value justifies the price.
- The demo is a conversation the buyer steers.

Source: consultative-selling practice

Why Deals Actually Stall

Most losses are not to a competitor. They are to a buyer who could not get to a confident decision.

61%

Lost to indecision

▼ of lost deals go to buyer indecision, not a rival

80%

Committee stalls

▼ of B2B committee decisions stall without consensus

60%

Say no first

• of prospects say no four times before saying yes

Your real competitor is usually 'do nothing'. Sell the cost of standing still as hard as you sell the solution.

Source: B2B sales-benchmark synthesis (alexberman.com) — industry-reported figures

T2

LO2 · LU2 · T2

a Great Demo

What is a Great Demo?

A demo that only shows features is a lecture. A demo that solves a stated problem is a conversation — and conversations close.



Educate — The What

Frame the problem so the solution makes sense.



Demonstrate — The How

Show the specific fix for their specific pain.



Buy-In — The Why

Let them picture their own team using it.



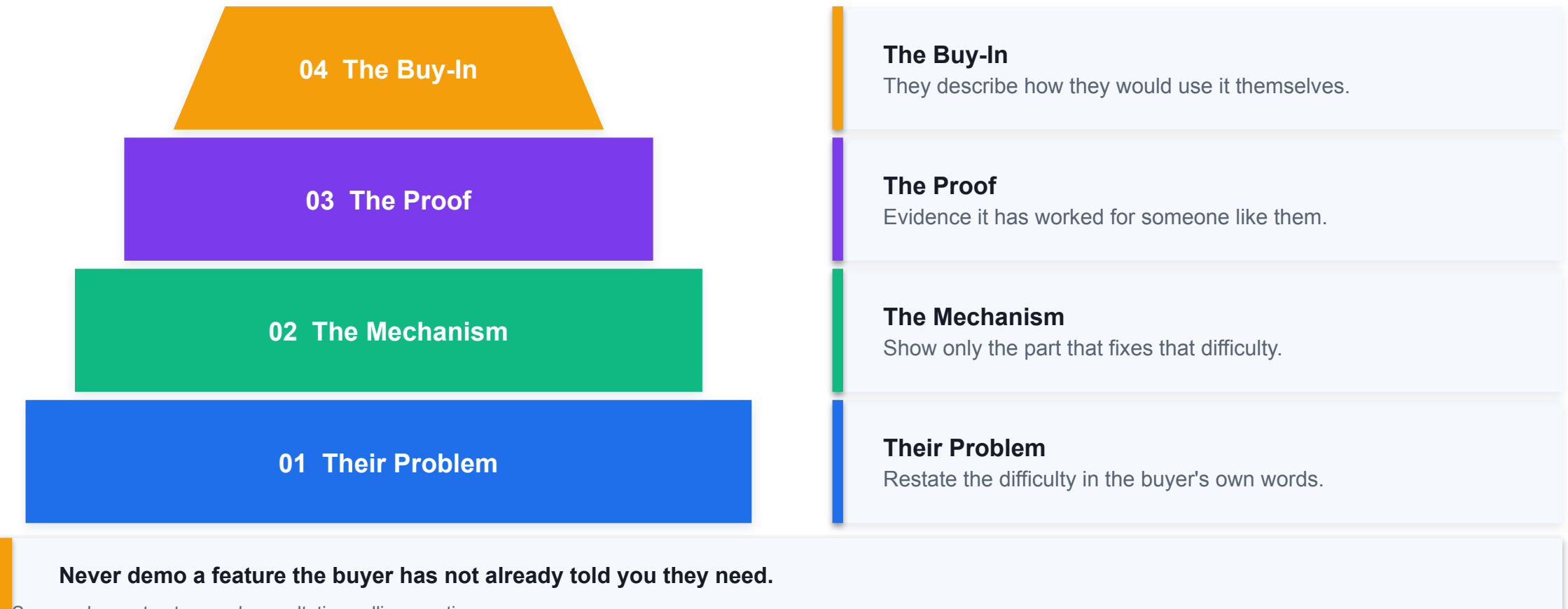
Confirm — The Check

Trial-close each section before moving on.

Source: demo-structure practice (Educate / Demonstrate / Buy-In)

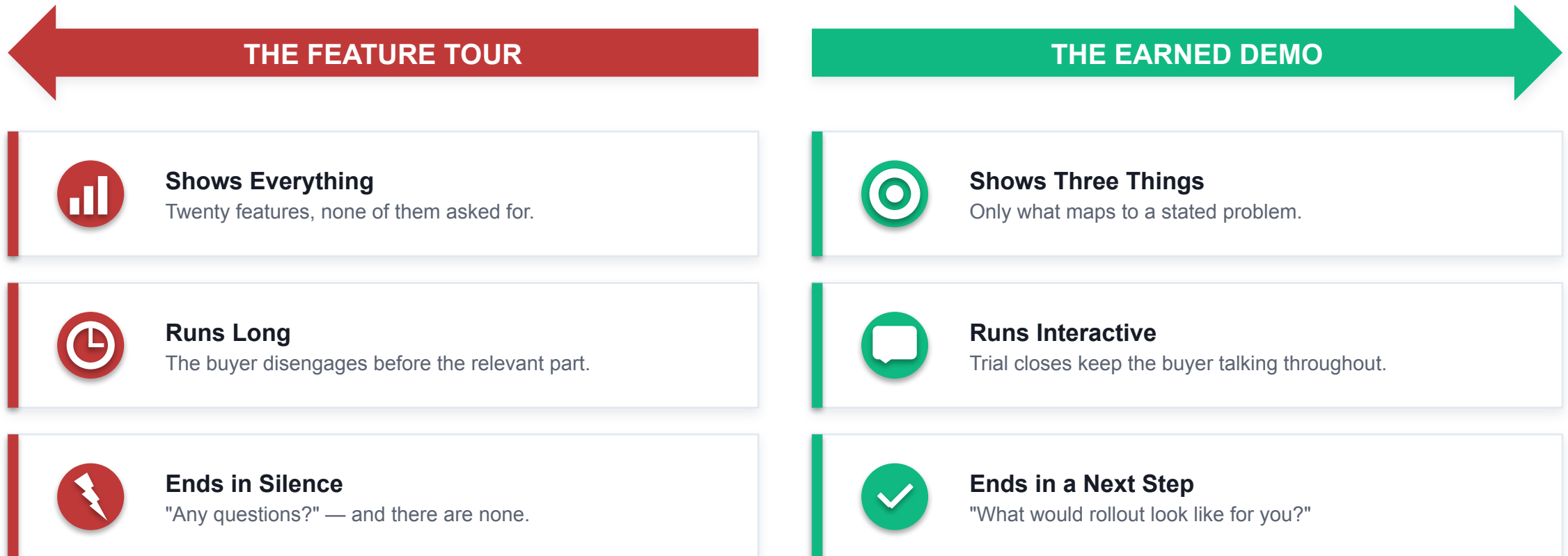
The Demo Pyramid — Build In This Order

Each level only holds if the one beneath it is solid. Jump to the top and the whole thing collapses into a features tour.



Source: demo-structure and consultative-selling practice

The Feature Tour vs The Earned Demo



Source: demo-effectiveness practice

Mini Closes — Small Yeses Along the Way

A big yes is terrifying. Five small yeses are easy — and they add up to the same signature.



The Sense Check

"Does that approach make sense so far?"



The Fit Check

"Is that closer to how your team works?"



The Gap Check

"Anything missing from what I've shown?"



The Forward Check

"Shall I show you how rollout would work?"

Source: trial-close / mini-close technique (alexberman.com; sales practice)

LO2 · LU2 · T3

Upselling & Cross-Selling

What is Upselling & Cross-Selling?

Upsell too early and you look greedy. Upsell after they've felt the win and you look like a partner. Timing IS the technique.



Upselling

A better version of the thing they already chose.



Cross-Selling

A genuinely related add-on that completes the job.



Earn the Right First

Only after the first purchase has delivered real value.



Relevance Over Revenue

An irrelevant add-on costs you the whole relationship.

Source: upsell / cross-sell practice

Upsell vs Cross-Sell — Know Which One You're Doing

U

Upselling

- Same need, higher tier or capacity.
- "You've hit the 10-user limit twice this month."
- Triggered by the customer outgrowing the plan.
- Risk: feels like a toll gate if raised too early.

X

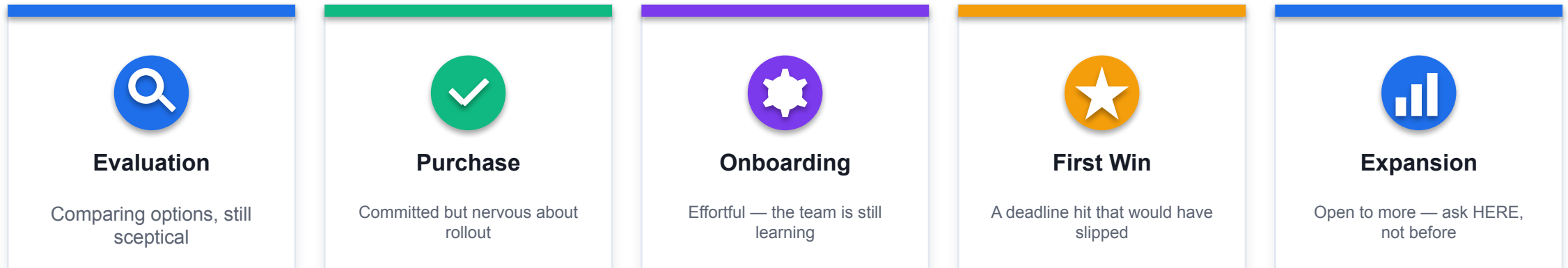
Cross-Selling

- Adjacent need, a different product entirely.
- "Site photos keep getting lost in chat — that's our mobile add-on."
- Triggered by a second problem surfacing in use.
- Risk: feels random if it isn't clearly connected.

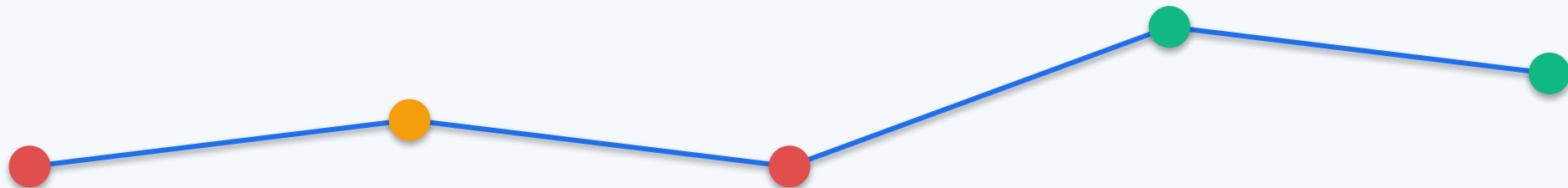
Source: upsell / cross-sell definitions, sales practice

When to Raise an Upsell — Follow the Customer's Confidence

Read the emotional arc. The only safe moment to expand the deal is after the first real win has landed.



HOW THE BUYER FEELS



Raising an add-on during the onboarding dip is the single most common upsell mistake — the customer is still paying for the last decision.

Source: customer-lifecycle and upsell-timing practice (illustrative arc)

LO2 · LU2 · T4

Personalisation

What is Personalisation?

Personalisation is not putting their first name in the subject line. It is proving you remember what they told you.



Reference the Specific

Name their actual project, team size or deadline.



Reuse Their Language

Quote the phrase they used to describe the pain.



Match the Buyer Type

Data for analytical buyers; brevity for decisive ones.

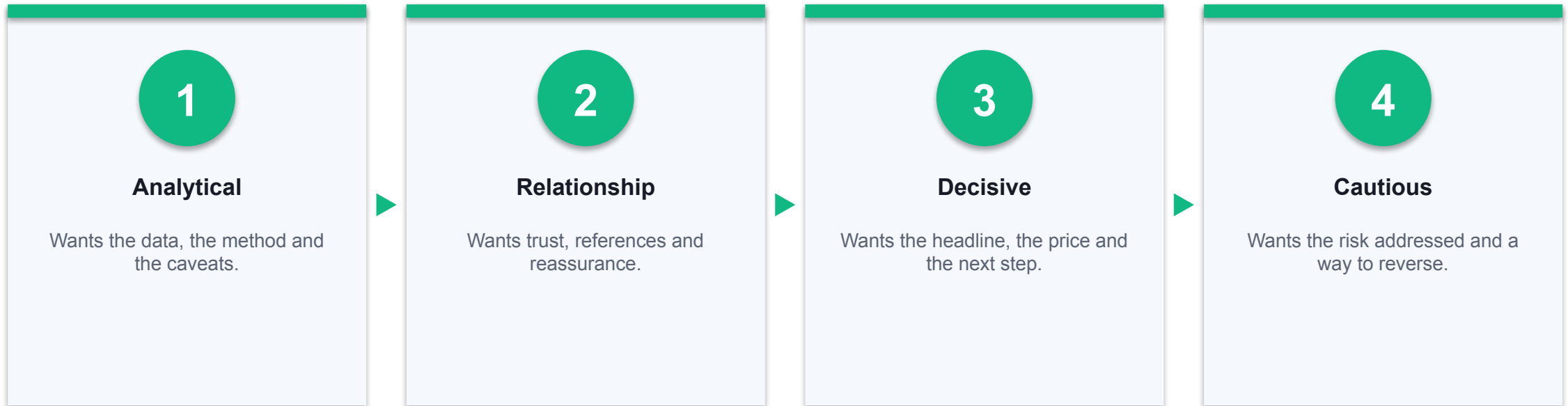


Time It to Their Cycle

Fit their budget calendar, not your quarter-end.

Source: personalisation and buyer-type adaptation practice

Adapting to the Buyer in Front of You



Selling to all four the same way means you are selling well to only one of them.

Source: buyer-personality adaptation, emotional-intelligence sales practice

Generic Pitch vs Personalised, Value-Earned Pitch

Generic Pitch

- "Customers love our premium tier."
- Could have been sent to any company on the list.
- Add-on raised at the first available opportunity.
- Buyer hears a quota being filled.

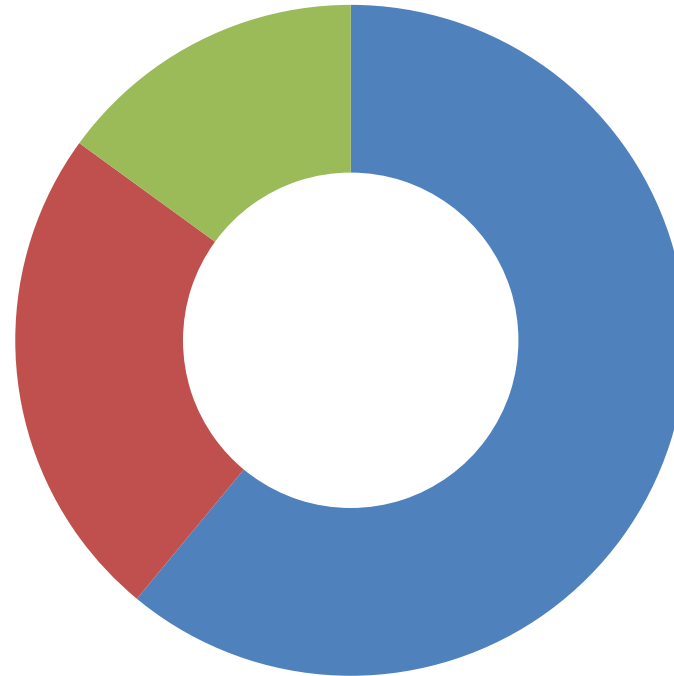
Personalised Pitch

- "You mentioned the Jurong handover — this is the piece that covers it."
- Could only have been written for this one buyer.
- Add-on raised after the first win was felt.
- Buyer hears a problem being solved.

Source: personalisation practice

Where B2B Deals Are Lost

Illustrative split of lost-deal causes — note how little of it is the competitor you were worried about.



■ Buyer indecision ■ Lost to a competitor ■ Budget withdrawn

Illustrative composition based on reported B2B lost-deal analysis.

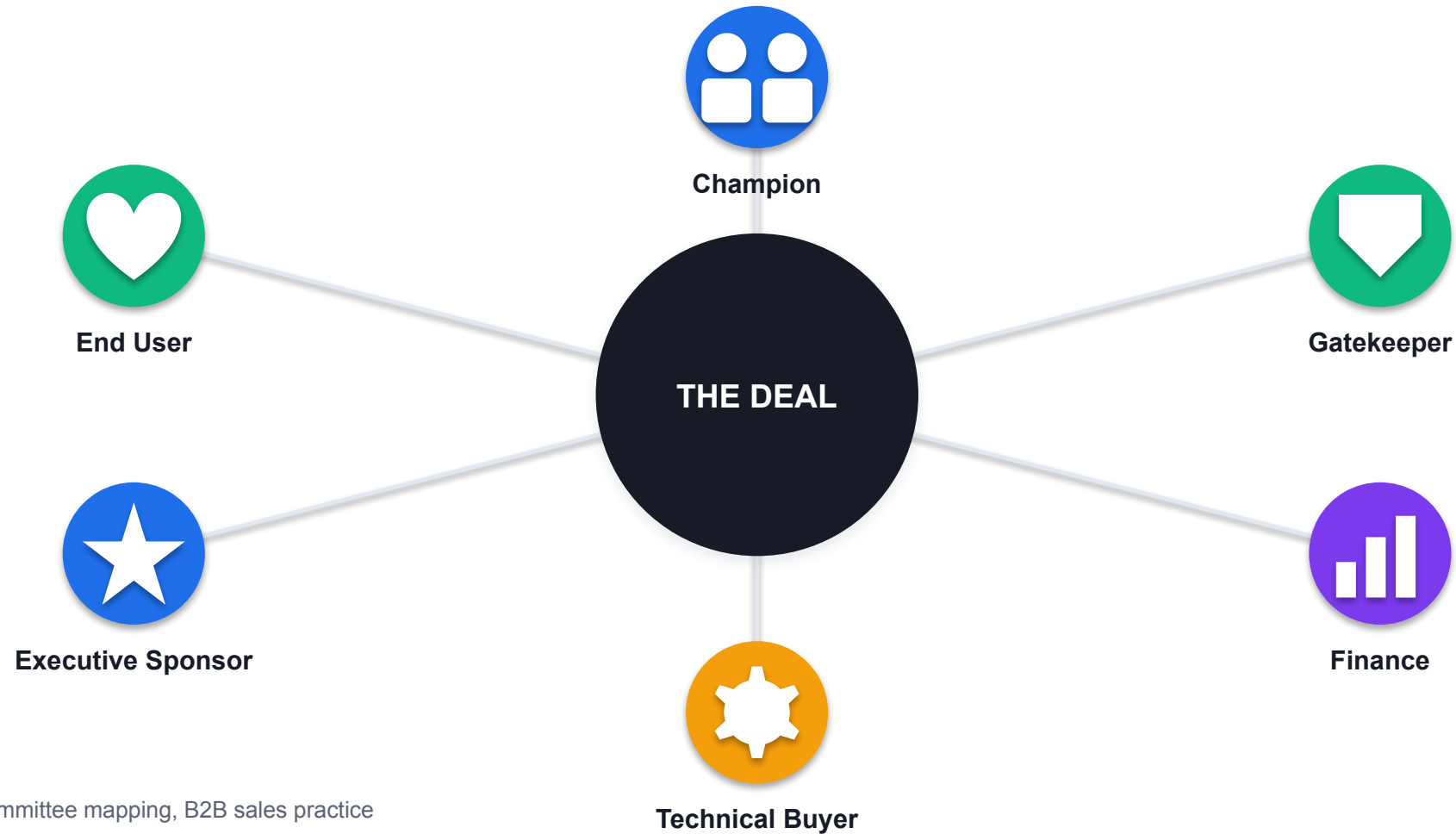
Source: B2B lost-deal synthesis (alexberman.com) — illustrative composition

T5

LO2 · LU2 · T5

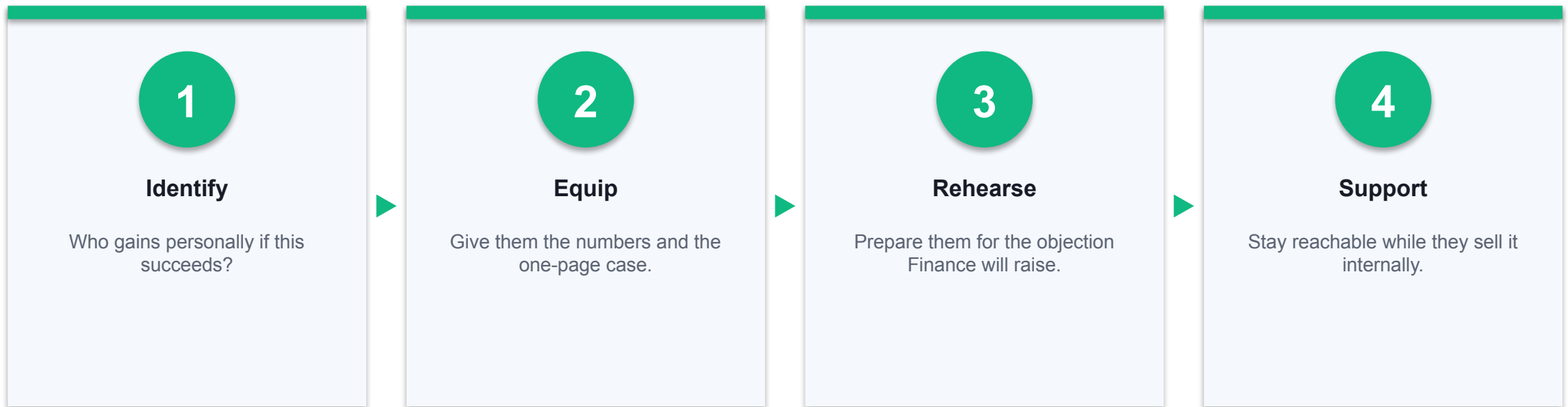
Champion Selling

What is Champion Selling?



Source: buying-committee mapping, B2B sales practice

How to Build a Champion



Your champion has to win an argument you will never be in the room for. Arm them for that argument, not for your demo.

Source: champion-selling and buying-committee practice

A Contact vs A Champion

A Contact

- Takes your call and likes the product.
- Forwards your deck without comment.
- Goes quiet when the deal meets resistance.
- Cannot tell you who else must approve it.

A Champion

- Gains personally when the project succeeds.
- Rewrites your case in their own internal language.
- Argues for it in the meeting you're not invited to.
- Names every stakeholder and their objection.

Source: champion-selling practice

The Three People You Must Convince at Sunrise Builders

Same deal, three completely different definitions of 'good'.

JT John Tan Project Manager · Champion GOALS • Stop deadlines slipping • See job status without chasing FRUSTRATIONS • Burned by a past rollout • No time to run a migration	PR Priya Raman Finance Director · Gatekeeper GOALS • Predictable annual cost • Clear payback period FRUSTRATIONS • Another recurring licence • Vague ROI claims	ML Marcus Lee Site Foreman · End User GOALS • Fewer status phone calls • Something usable on site FRUSTRATIONS • Typing reports on a phone • Anything with training
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Source: buying-committee personas, grounded in this course's role-play scenario

Land-and-Expand: Why the Second Sale Is Easier Than the First

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Salesforce

Salesforce built its growth on the land-and-expand model — win a small team first, prove value, then expand across departments. The principle generalises: the cheapest deal you will ever close is the next one with a customer who has already felt a win.

Role Play: Selling Techniques & Problem-Solving

ROLE PLAY

THE SITUATION

Alex is a sales rep for a CRM platform. Emma is Marketing Director at Northlight Retail, a growing Singapore chain with 14 outlets. Her team runs campaigns from a mix of spreadsheets, a mailing tool and WhatsApp groups. Last quarter a promotion went out twice to the same 4,000 customers, and a complaint reached the CEO.

Emma has already had one discovery call with Alex and agreed to a 45-minute demo. She is genuinely interested but has two unspoken worries: her team is not technical, and she has to justify any new spend to a finance director who has just frozen new software purchases.

The scene covers the demo itself — Educate, Demonstrate, Buy-In — with mini closes along the way, then Emma's concern about ease of use, and finally Alex's decision about whether (and when) to raise the automation add-on that would genuinely help her, without derailing the core deal.

You'll produce: A completed Demo & Upsell Observer Scorecard citing the three problem-mapped features, the mini closes used, and the upsell timing decision with its signal

Duration: 1 hour

Role Play: Selling Techniques & Problem-Solving

ASSIGN THE ROLES

Alex — Sales Rep, CRM Platform

GOAL

Run a problem-led demo, earn buy-in with mini closes, and judge the upsell moment

Must resist demoing all 20 features. Only three of them map to what Emma actually said. The upsell is real and useful — but raising it before Emma has committed to the core product will cost the deal.

Emma — Marketing Director, Northlight Retail

GOAL

Decide whether this solves the duplicate-send problem without breaking her team

Interested but cautious. Will ask 'how easy is it for my team to get started?' — the real question underneath is 'will I be blamed if they don't use it?' She has a finance director who has frozen new spend.

Observer / Coach

GOAL

Score the demo structure, the mini closes and the upsell timing

Tracks whether Alex educated before demonstrating, how many mini closes were used and whether they were genuine, and whether the upsell was raised at a moment Emma was ready for — quoting the exact lines.

Role Play: Selling Techniques & Problem-Solving

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

- 1 Did Alex educate before demonstrating, or jump straight to the product? What was the cost either way?
- 2 Which three features did Alex choose to show — and were they the three Emma actually named?
- 3 Count the mini closes. Which ones were genuine checks, and which were rhetorical questions that didn't invite a real answer?
- 4 Emma asked 'how easy is it to get started?' What was the real question underneath, and did Alex answer that one?
- 5 Was the upsell raised at the right moment? What signal would have told Alex to wait — or to go?
- 6 How did Alex equip Emma to win the argument with her finance director when he wasn't in the room?

Role Play: Selling Techniques & Problem-Solving

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- What did showing fewer features do to the quality of the conversation?
- Which mini close would you steal for your own next demo?
- Where is the line between a helpful upsell and one that costs you the core deal?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

The observer can name the three features shown and tie each to something Emma said, quote at least two genuine mini closes, identify the real question behind 'how easy is it?', and state whether the upsell was correctly timed — with the signal that justified the call.

Recap — Selling Techniques & Problem-Solving

1

Problem-Based Selling

You can now: lead with the customer's stated problem rather than the product's feature list.

2

Running a Great Demo

You can now: structure a demonstration around Educate, Demonstrate and Buy-In.

3

Upselling & Cross-Selling

You can now: apply upselling and cross-selling with the right timing and genuine relevance.

4

Personalisation That Converts

You can now: personalise a recommendation to the buyer's stated problem rather than a generic pitch.

5

Champion Selling

You can now: identify, equip and mobilise an internal champion across the buying committee.

6

Role Play: Selling Techniques & Problem-Solving

You practised: run a problem-led demo, apply mini closes, and time an upsell correctly.

LU2 · WHY IT MATTERS

A demo that only shows features is a lecture. A demo that solves a stated problem is a conversation.

— Closing thought, LU2: Selling Techniques & Problem-Solving

LU3

LU3

Closing the Sale

Buying Signals · Closing Techniques · Justifying Price · Easy to Buy · Follow-Up

Key Concepts — Closing the Sale

1

A close is the culmination of the whole sales cycle, not a single trick — read verbal, behavioural and digital buying signals before you ever ask.

2

Choose an ethical close that fits the moment — Summary, Thermometer, Test Drive or Empathy Close — never manufactured urgency or pressure.

3

Justify price with value and ROI before discounting is even on the table; frequent discounting quietly devalues everything else you said.

4

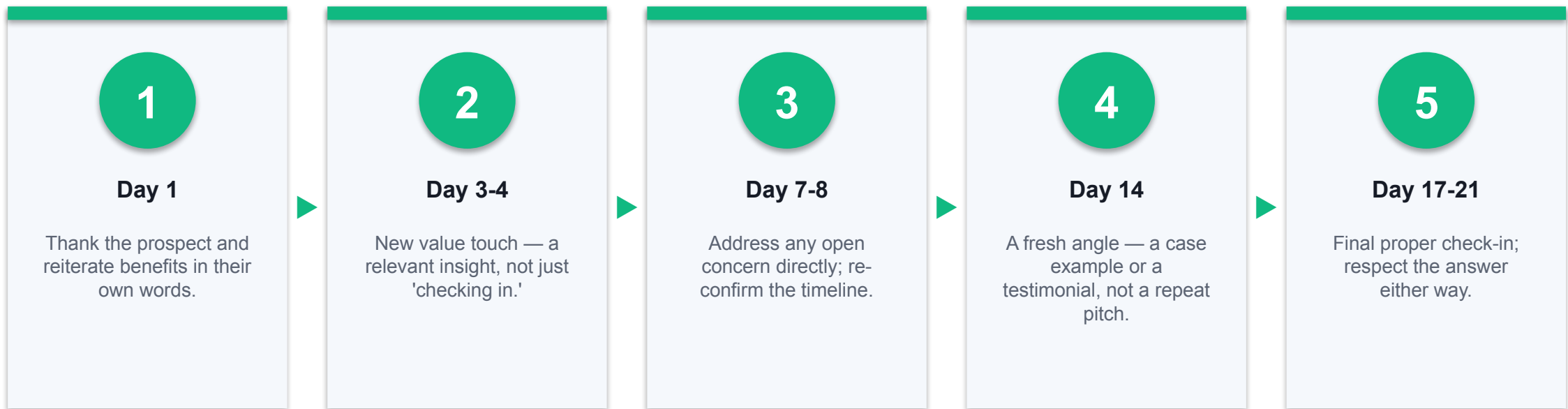
Make it easy to buy: simple contracts, a dated mutual action plan with named owners, and de-risked options like a pilot.

5

Follow up properly: 80% of sales need 5-12 touches across a 17-21 day window, and every touch must carry new value.

A 17-21 Day Follow-Up Cadence

Most sales need 5 or more follow-up touches — space them roughly 2-3 days apart across a 17-21 day window instead of one call and silence.



80% of sales need 5-12 follow-ups — and most sellers stop after just one.

The Empathy-Driven Closing Set

Six techniques that still work when the buyer knows exactly what you are doing — because none of them depend on pressure.



Summary Close

Recap the agreement, then ask if it sounds right.



Visual Close

Show the decision as a chart, timeline or checklist.



Backwards Close

Ask who else needs this — fit over any fit.



Storytelling Close

A case study they can see themselves inside.



Thermometer Close

"One to ten — and why not a ten?"



Assumptive Close

Address the concern, then move to logistics.

Source: empathy-driven sales-closing techniques (mapmycustomers; monday.com; Indeed)

T1

LO3 · LU3 · T1

a Close

What is a Close?

The close is not a moment of pressure at the end. It is the natural consequence of everything you did before it.



Build Rapport

Establish a genuine connection with the prospect.



Present Value

Demonstrate the benefit in the buyer's own terms.



Ask Clearly

Finalise with an explicit, confident request.

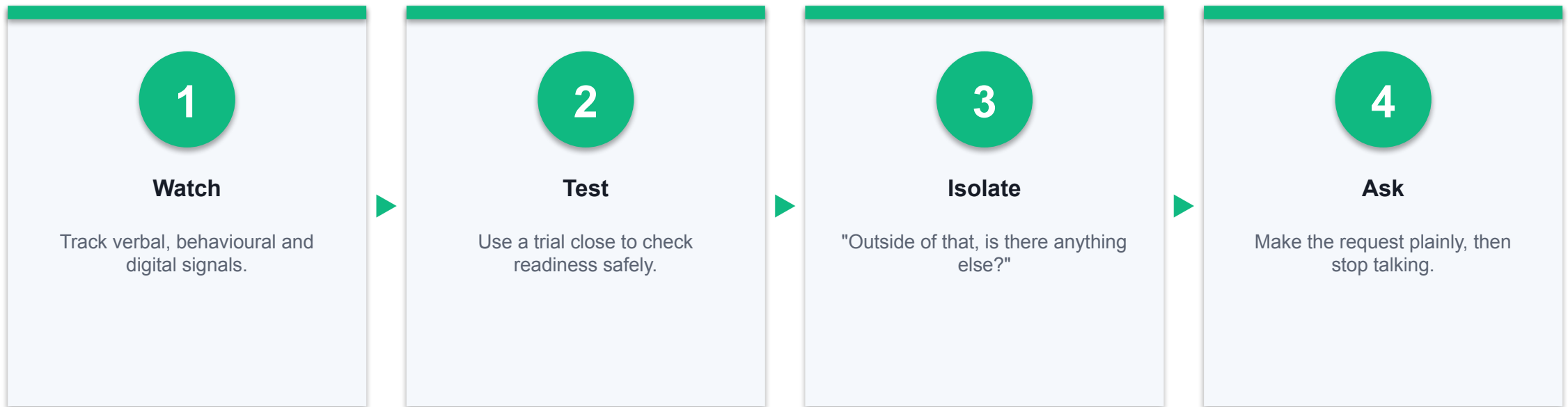


Culmination

The end result of the cycle — never an isolated trick.

Source: sales-cycle and closing practice

Reading the Room Before You Ask



Nearly half of sales calls end without the seller ever asking. The silence after the ask belongs to the buyer — do not fill it.

Source: closing practice; isolation question (alexberman.com)

Pushy Closing vs Empathy-Driven Closing

Pushy Closing

- Manufactured urgency: "this price ends tonight."
- Treats the objection as an obstacle to steamroll.
- Asks for the signature regardless of readiness.
- Wins the deal, loses the referral and the renewal.

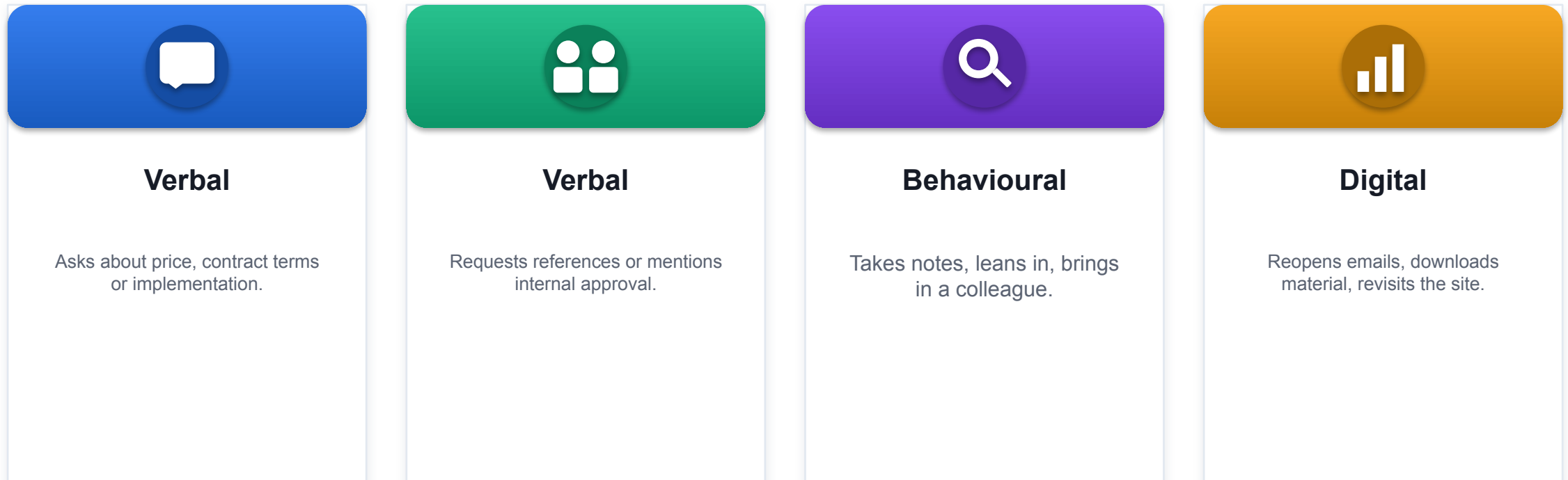
Empathy-Driven Closing

- Real deadlines only, stated plainly and honestly.
- Treats the objection as information to work with.
- Asks when the signals say the buyer is ready.
- Wins the deal, the referral and the renewal.

Source: empathy-driven closing practice

Buying Signals — What 'Ready' Actually Looks Like

Stop guessing. Buyers tell you they are ready in three distinct channels.



Source: buying-signal taxonomy (monday.com; sales practice)

LO3 · LU3 · T2

Closing Techniques

What is Closing Techniques?

There are over a hundred named closes. These are the ones that still work when the buyer knows exactly what you are doing.



The Summary Close

Recap what was agreed, then ask if that sounds right.



The Visual Close

Show the decision as a chart, timeline or checklist.



The Thermometer Close

"On a scale of one to ten, where are you?"

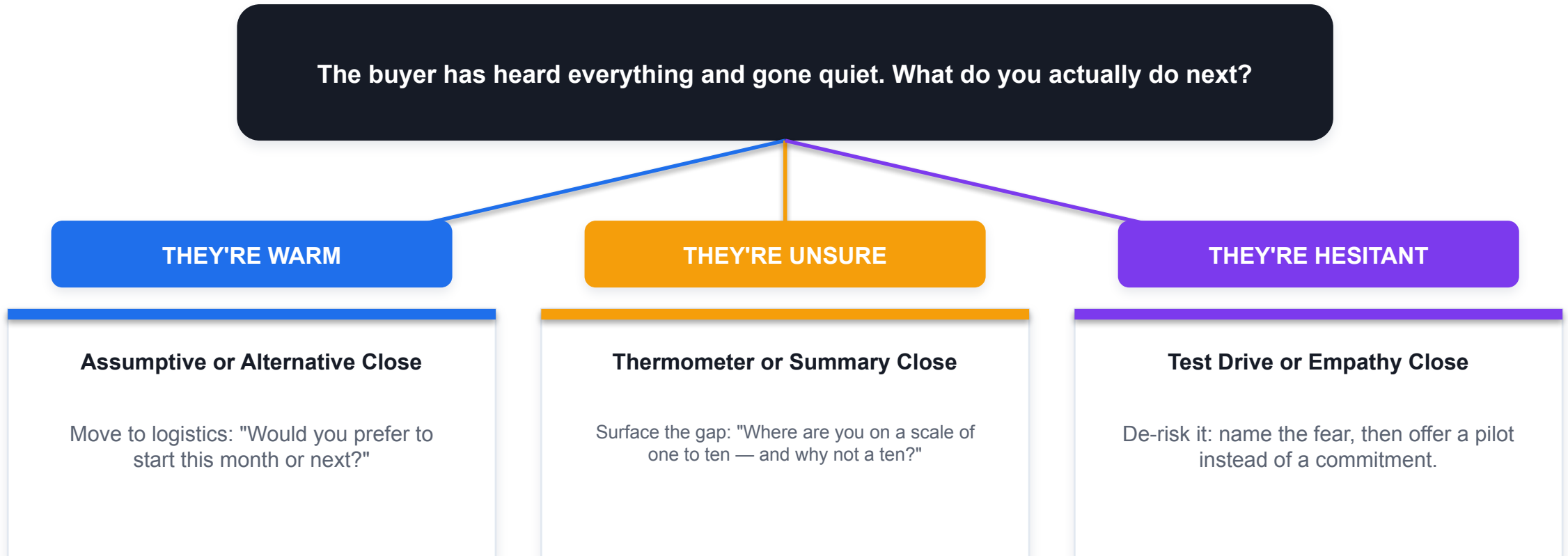


The Empathy Close

Name the concern honestly, then reinforce the value.

Source: empathy-driven closing techniques (mapmycustomers; monday.com)

Which Close Fits the Moment?



Source: closing-technique selection, synthesised from named closes

Ethical Closes vs Pressure Closes

Use These

- Summary Close — confirms mutual understanding.
- Thermometer/Scale Close — invites the real objection.
- Test Drive / Puppy Dog Close — lets the product prove itself.
- Alternative Close — two genuine, good options.

Avoid These

- Manufactured scarcity — a deadline you invented.
- Guilt Close — leveraging obligation or family pressure.
- Sudden Death Close — "decide right now or we're done."
- Any close that relies on the buyer not thinking clearly.

Source: closing-technique taxonomy (Stowell, 100+ closes) filtered for ethical practice

Six More Closes Worth Knowing

Match the technique to the buyer in front of you — not to your favourite.



Storytelling Close

A case study they can see themselves inside.



Backwards Close

Ask who else needs this — signals fit over any fit.



Sharp Angle Close

Trade a real concession for a real commitment.



Ben Franklin Close

Build the pros and cons list together.



Columbo Close

"Just one more thing..." after the no.



Takeaway Close

Remove the option that isn't earning its price.

Source: named closing techniques (Indeed; Stowell; monday.com)

LO3 · LU3 · T3

Justifying the Price

What is Justifying the Price?

Discounting is the fastest way to tell a buyer that your first price was not honest. Lead with value, every time.



Emphasise Value

Show ROI and outcome, not the feature count.



Support With Evidence

Back the claim with data, studies and testimonials.



Frame the Long Term

Total cost of ownership, not this month's invoice.

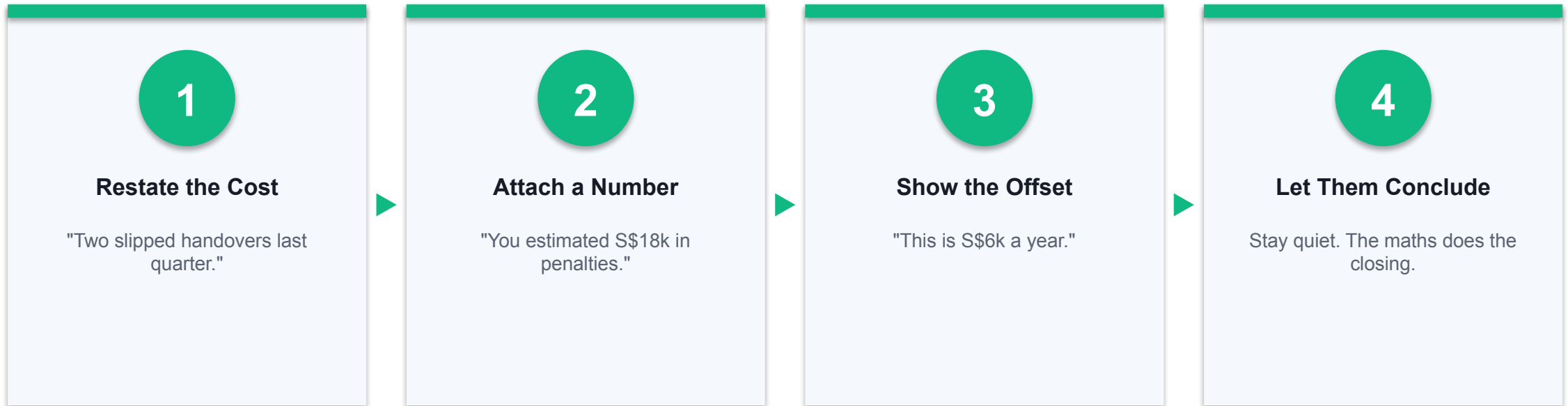


Quantify Inaction

What does NOT solving it cost them per month?

Source: value-based pricing and ROI-justification practice

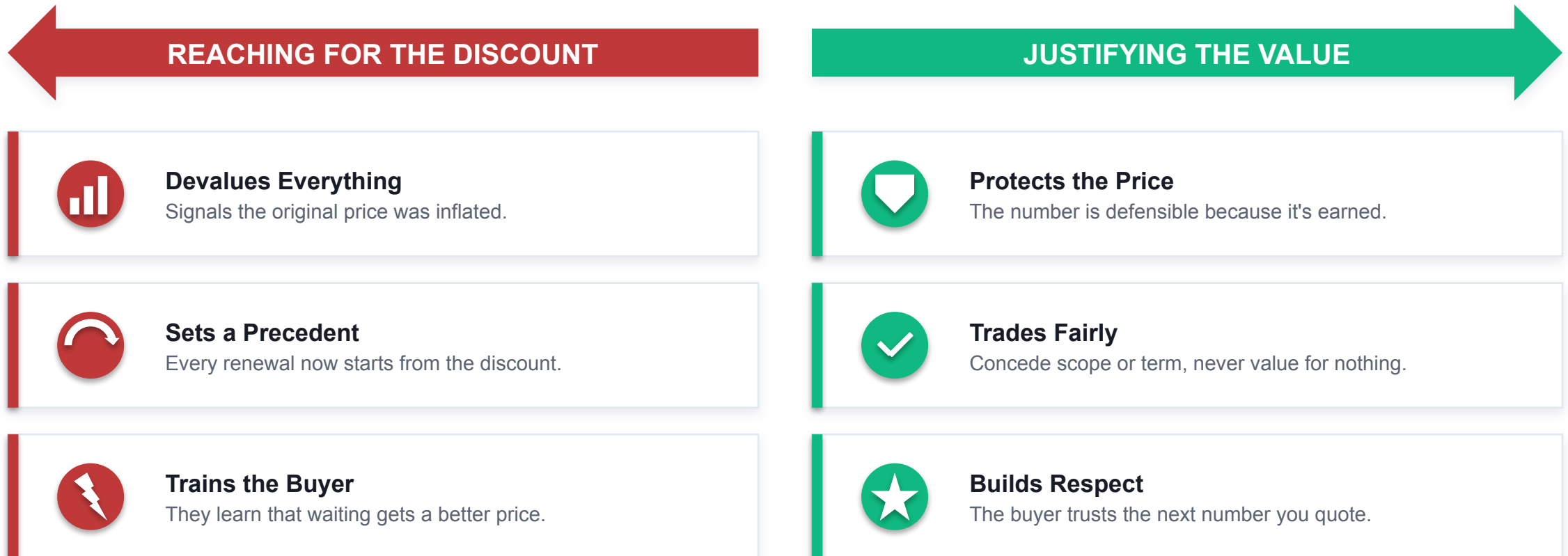
The Value Conversation, In Order



If you cannot express the value as a number the buyer agrees with, you are not ready to discuss price at all.

Source: ROI-based price-justification practice

Discounting vs Value-Justifying



Source: pricing-integrity and negotiation practice

The Cost of Standing Still — Sunrise Builders

Illustrative worked example from the LU1 scenario. This is the arithmetic that closes a price objection.

\$18k

Cost of inaction

- ▼ estimated penalties from two slipped handovers

\$6k

Annual cost

- of the proposed solution, all users included

3x

First-year return

- ▲ value returned against cost in year one

Illustrative worked example — build the same three-number case for your own product before your next price conversation.

Source: illustrative ROI worked example, built on this course's scenario

LO3 · LU3 · T4

Making It Easy to Buy

What is Making It Easy to Buy?

Every extra form, approval and unanswered question is a place your deal can quietly die. Remove them before the buyer finds them.



Simplify the Process

Clear contracts, simple terms,
obvious payment options.



Provide Next Steps

A dated timeline so nobody
wonders what happens now.



Name the Owner

Say exactly who does what,
and by when.

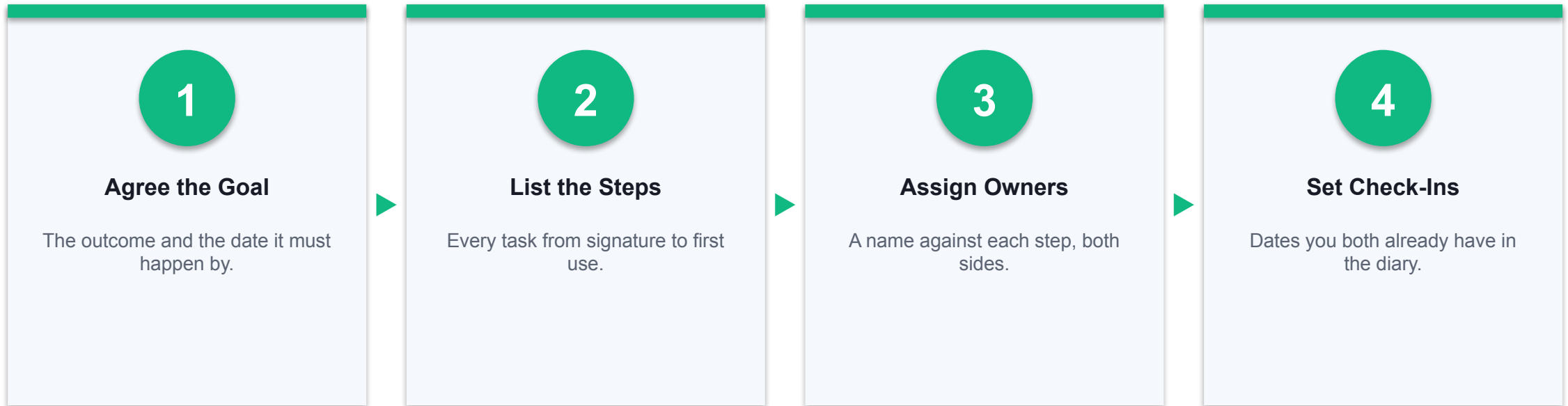


De-Risk the Decision

Pilot, trial or staged rollout instead
of all-or-nothing.

Source: buying-friction reduction practice

The Mutual Action Plan



A mutual action plan turns 'we'll get back to you' into a shared document with your name and theirs on it.

Source: mutual action plan / close-plan practice (alexberman.com)

High-Friction vs Low-Friction Buying

High Friction

- A 14-page contract with no summary.
- "Someone from onboarding will be in touch."
- Buyer must chase you for the next step.
- All-or-nothing commitment with no exit.

Low Friction

- A one-page summary attached to the contract.
- "Priya starts your setup on the 4th at 10am."
- The next step is already in both calendars.
- A 30-day pilot with a clear success measure.

Source: buying-experience practice

Where Buyers Drop Out After 'Yes'

Illustrative post-agreement drop-off. Most of this is process friction, not a change of heart.



Every stage you fail to plan for is a stage where the deal can quietly die.

Source: illustrative post-agreement drop-off, deal-desk practice

T5

LO3 · LU3 · T5

Proper Follow-Up

What is Proper Follow-Up?

Most sellers quit after one follow-up. Most sales close after five. That gap is the cheapest money in this entire course.



Be Persistent, Not Pushy

Every touch carries new value,
never just 'checking in'.



Thank and Reiterate

Restate the benefit in the
buyer's own words.



Respect Boundaries

Honour a real no — and leave the
door genuinely open.



Address Open Concerns

Answer the thing they didn't quite
say last time.

Source: sales follow-up practice

A 17-21 Day Follow-Up Cadence

Most sales need five or more touches. Space them 2-3 days apart, and give each one a reason to exist.

Day 1 Touch 1

Thank them; reiterate the benefit in their words.

Day 3-4 Touch 2

New value — a relevant insight, not 'just checking in'.

Day 7-8 Touch 3

Address the open concern; re-confirm the timeline.

Day 14 Touch 4

A fresh angle — a case example or testimonial.

Day 17-21 Touch
5

Final proper check-in; respect the answer either way.

80% of sales need 5-12 touches — and most sellers stop after one.

Source: follow-up cadence synthesis (Lusha via monday.com); industry-reported figures

'Just Checking In' vs A Value Touch

Just Checking In

- "Hi, just following up on my last email."
- Gives the buyer nothing new to react to.
- Puts the work of replying entirely on them.
- Easy to ignore without any guilt.

A Value Touch

- "Your competitor just published their delay stats — worth two minutes."
- Carries something genuinely useful every time.
- Makes replying the easy and interesting option.
- Builds a reason to stay in the conversation.

Source: follow-up quality practice

The Follow-Up Gap

The single widest gap between what works and what most sellers actually do.

5-12

Touches needed

▲ before 80% of sales actually close

1

Touches attempted

▼ by the typical seller before giving up

17-21

Day window

- the cadence should span, at 2-3 day intervals

Nothing else in this course returns as much for as little effort as simply following up properly.

Source: follow-up benchmark synthesis (Lusha via monday.com) — industry-reported figures

When Sales Targets Outrun Ethics, the Whole Franchise Pays

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Wells Fargo

Wells Fargo's cross-selling scandal — millions of unauthorised accounts opened under intense sales quotas — led to a US\$3bn settlement in 2020 and lasting reputational damage. It is the clearest possible argument that pressure-based selling is a business risk, not just an ethical one.

Role Play: Closing the Sale

ROLE PLAY

THE SITUATION

Mark sells a marketing-automation platform. Rachel is Marketing Director at Harbourfront Living, a large Singapore e-commerce retailer. Over three conversations Mark has shown that automating their abandoned-cart and re-order campaigns would recover an estimated S\$140k a year in lost revenue.

Rachel wants it. But her budget for the year is committed, and her CFO has asked every department to defer new software to the next financial year. She opens this call by asking for a 25% discount — which is not really about the money.

The scene covers reading Rachel's buying signals, holding the price while genuinely solving her budget-timing problem, using a mini close to confirm agreement in stages, making the buying process easy, and closing on a concrete mutual action plan with dates and owners.

You'll produce: A completed Closing Observer Scorecard citing the buying signals, the real constraint, the price-holding trade, the closing technique used, and the mutual action plan agreed

Duration: 1 hour

Role Play: Closing the Sale

ASSIGN THE ROLES

Mark — Sales Rep, Marketing Automation

GOAL

Close the deal without discounting, by solving the real constraint

Has authority to vary payment terms and start date, but NOT the headline price. Must work out that Rachel's discount request is really a budget-timing problem — and that a deferred start or staged billing solves it where a discount would not.

Rachel — Marketing Director, Harbourfront Living

GOAL

Get the platform approved without breaking the CFO's spending freeze

Genuinely wants the product; opens by asking for 25% off because that is the only lever she thinks she has. Her real constraint is WHEN the money can be spent, not how much. She will reveal this only if asked well.

Observer / Coach

GOAL

Score signal-reading, price-holding and the quality of the close

Tracks the buying signals Mark noticed (and missed), whether he discounted or solved, which closing technique he used and whether it fitted the moment, and whether the call ended with a dated mutual action plan.

Role Play: Closing the Sale

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

- 1 What buying signals did Rachel give in the first three minutes — and did Mark act on them or talk past them?
- 2 Rachel asked for 25% off. What was the real constraint underneath, and which question surfaced it?
- 3 Did Mark hold the price? If he conceded, what did he get in return — and was it a fair trade?
- 4 Which closing technique did Mark use, and was it the right one for Rachel's actual state of readiness?
- 5 How did Mark make it easy to buy? What friction did he remove — and what did he leave in place?
- 6 Did the call end with a dated mutual action plan naming owners, or with 'let me come back to you'?

Role Play: Closing the Sale

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- What would have happened to the relationship if Mark had simply granted the 25%?
- Which question best separated the stated objection from the real constraint?
- What is your own equivalent of 'vary the terms, hold the price' in your product?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

The observer can quote at least two buying signals Rachel gave, state the real constraint behind the discount request and the question that surfaced it, name the closing technique used, and confirm whether the call closed on a dated mutual action plan with named owners.

Recap — Closing the Sale

1

What a Close Really Is

You can now: recognise the close as the culmination of the sales cycle, not a single trick.

2

Closing Techniques That Respect the Buyer

You can now: select and apply an appropriate, ethical closing technique for the situation.

3

Justifying the Price

You can now: justify price with value and ROI before any discount is considered.

4

Making It Easy to Buy

You can now: remove friction from the buying process so the decision feels simple and safe.

5

Proper Follow-Up

You can now: design a persistent, value-adding follow-up cadence that is never pushy.

6

Role Play: Closing the Sale

You practised: read buying signals, justify price without discounting, and close with a mutual next step.

LU3 · WHY IT MATTERS

Nobody wants to be sold. Everybody wants to make a decision that feels easy and safe.

— Closing thought, LU3: Closing the Sale

LU4

Handling Objections & Rejections

Objection vs Deflection vs Rejection · Answer & Ask · Composure · Testimonials · Metrics

Key Concepts — Handling Objections & Rejections

1

An objection asks for more information, a deflection avoids the real issue, and a rejection is a genuine no — each needs a different response.

2

Acknowledge, Clarify, Address, Confirm — validate the feeling before you answer the fact, then isolate with 'outside of that, anything else?'.

3

Answer & Ask resolves the stated concern directly, then re-engages the conversation with a question instead of going quiet.

4

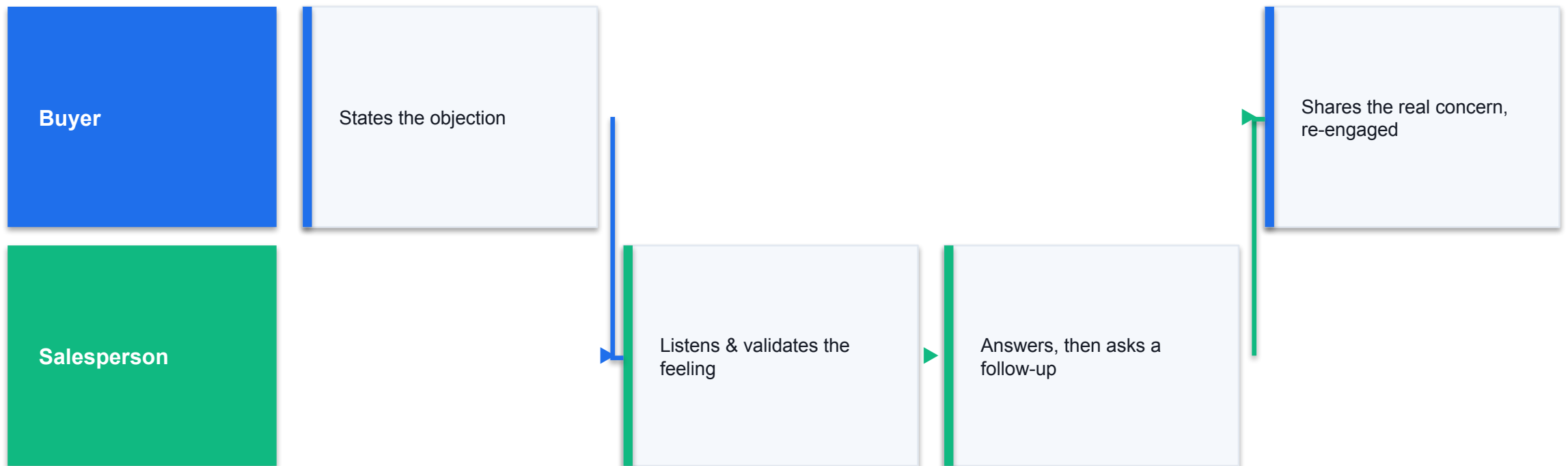
Composure is trainable: pause, label, reframe, respond, reassess — your own regulation protects the deal when the buyer gets short.

5

Metrics — conversion rate, cycle length, discount depth, NPS at handoff — turn 'closing better' into something the organisation can track and improve.

The Empathy-Driven Objection Hand-Off

Watch where control of the exchange passes between buyer and salesperson — validation always comes before the answer, not after.

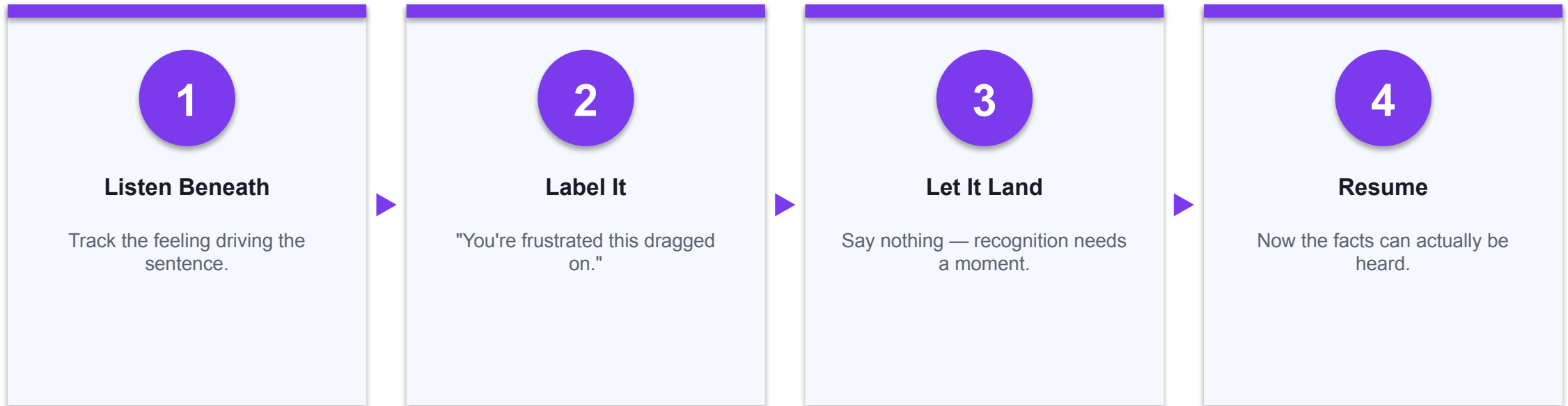


Source: empathy-driven objection-handling framework, sales-communication practice

Skipping straight from 'objection' to 'answer' — with no validation step — is the single most common reason a resolved objection still doesn't feel resolved.

Affect Labelling — Doug Noll's 90-Second Move

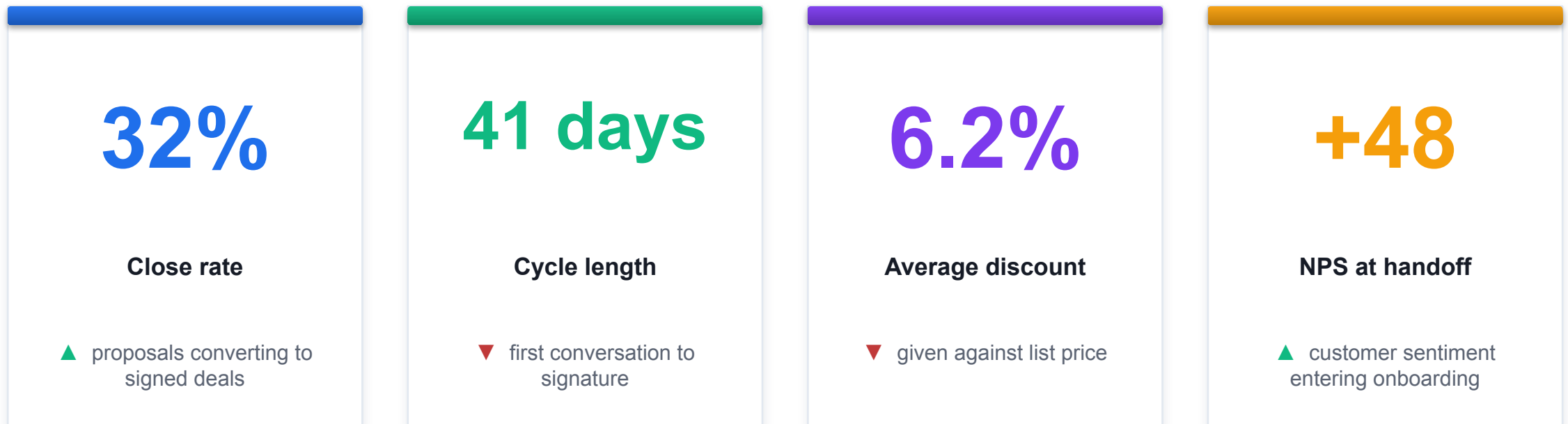
Listen to the emotions, not the words. Naming a feeling out loud dampens the brain's reactive centres and restores rational dialogue — often in under 90 seconds.



You cannot reason someone out of an emotional state. Name it first, and the reasoning becomes possible.

Evaluating the Sales Closure Process

Illustrative quarterly scorecard. These four numbers turn 'close better' into something an organisation can actually manage.



A falling cycle length and a falling discount depth, together, are the clearest evidence that value selling is working.

Source: illustrative sales-closure scorecard, performance-management practice

LO4 · LU4 · T1

Objection, Deflection & Rejection

What is Objection, Deflection & Rejection?

Three things that sound identical and need completely opposite responses. Misread it, and you either give up on a live deal or push a dead one.



An Objection

A request for more information.
The deal is alive.



A Deflection

Avoiding the real issue.
Something is unsaid.



A Rejection

A genuine no. Respect it and keep
the door open.

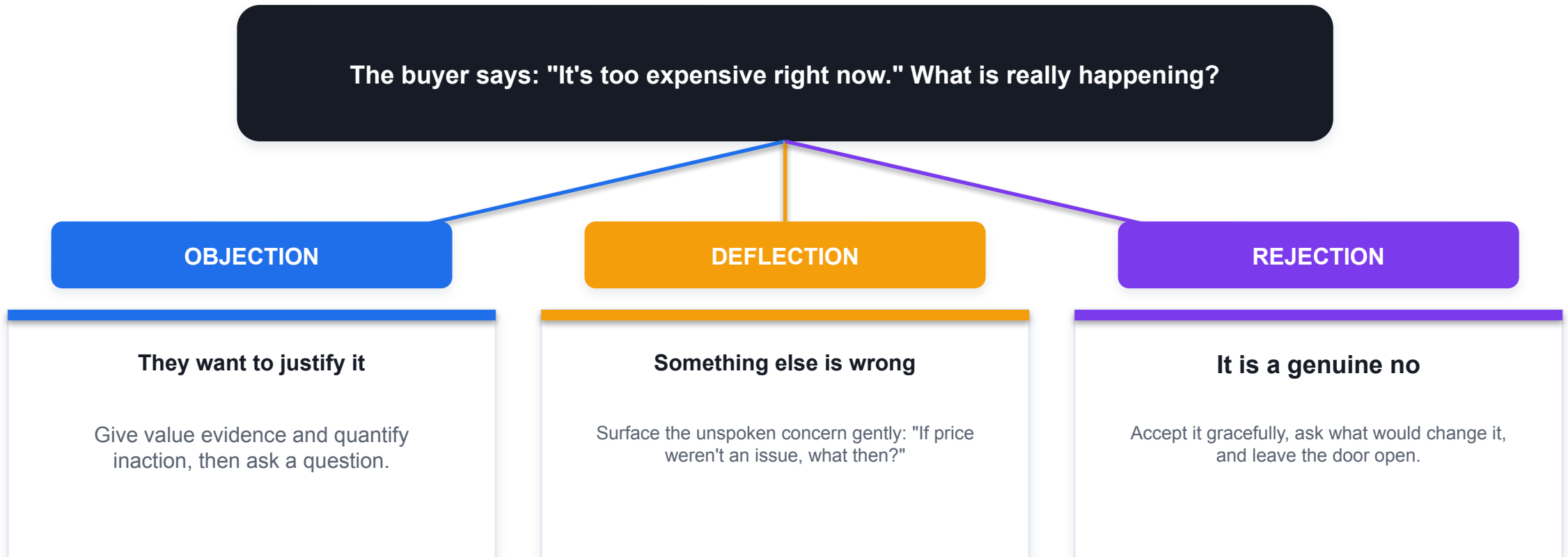


The Test

Ask a question — the answer tells
you which one it is.

Source: objection-handling taxonomy, sales practice

Which One Are You Actually Hearing?



Source: objection / deflection / rejection diagnosis practice

Reading the Difference in Practice

Signals an Objection

- Asks a follow-up question about terms or scope.
- Engages with your answer and pushes back on detail.
- Talks about 'when' and 'how', not 'whether'.
- Still willing to book the next conversation.

Signals a Rejection

- Gives no reason and asks nothing further.
- Answers in short, closed sentences.
- Shifts to the past tense: "we were looking at".
- Declines to schedule any next step.

Source: objection-handling practice

The Four Objections You Will Hear Most

Prepare these four properly and you have prepared for most of your career.



"Too expensive"

Usually a value gap or a timing constraint.



"Not the right time"

Usually a priority contest you haven't won.



"I need to consult"

Usually a committee you haven't mapped.



"We're happy as we are"

Usually inertia, not genuine satisfaction.

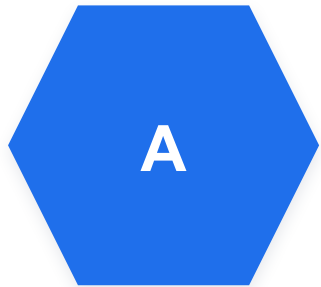
Source: common-objection taxonomy, sales practice

LO4 · LU4 · T2

the Objection-Handling Framework

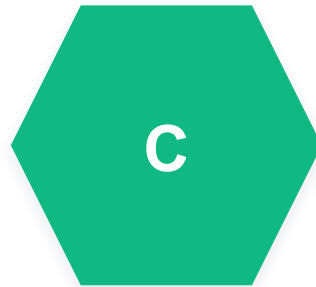
What is the Objection-Handling Framework?

Validation always comes before the answer. Skip it and even a correct answer leaves the buyer feeling unheard.



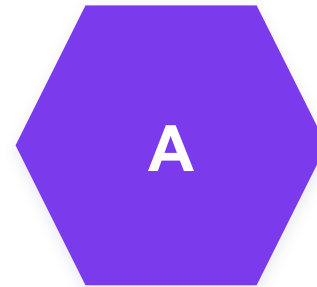
Acknowledge

Validate the feeling before touching the facts.



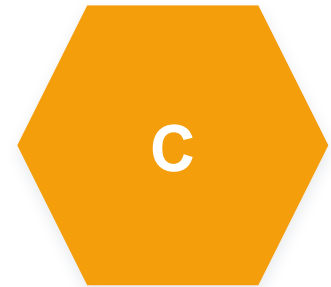
Clarify

Ask what specifically sits behind the concern.



Address

Answer the real concern with evidence.

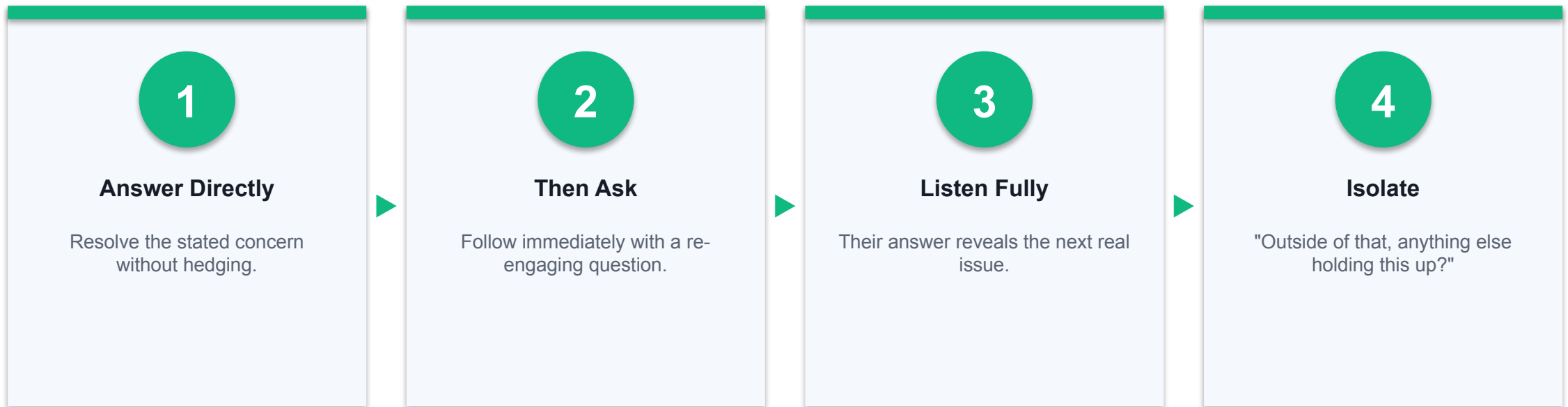


Confirm

Check it actually landed before moving on.

Source: objection-handling framework (alexberman.com; sales practice)

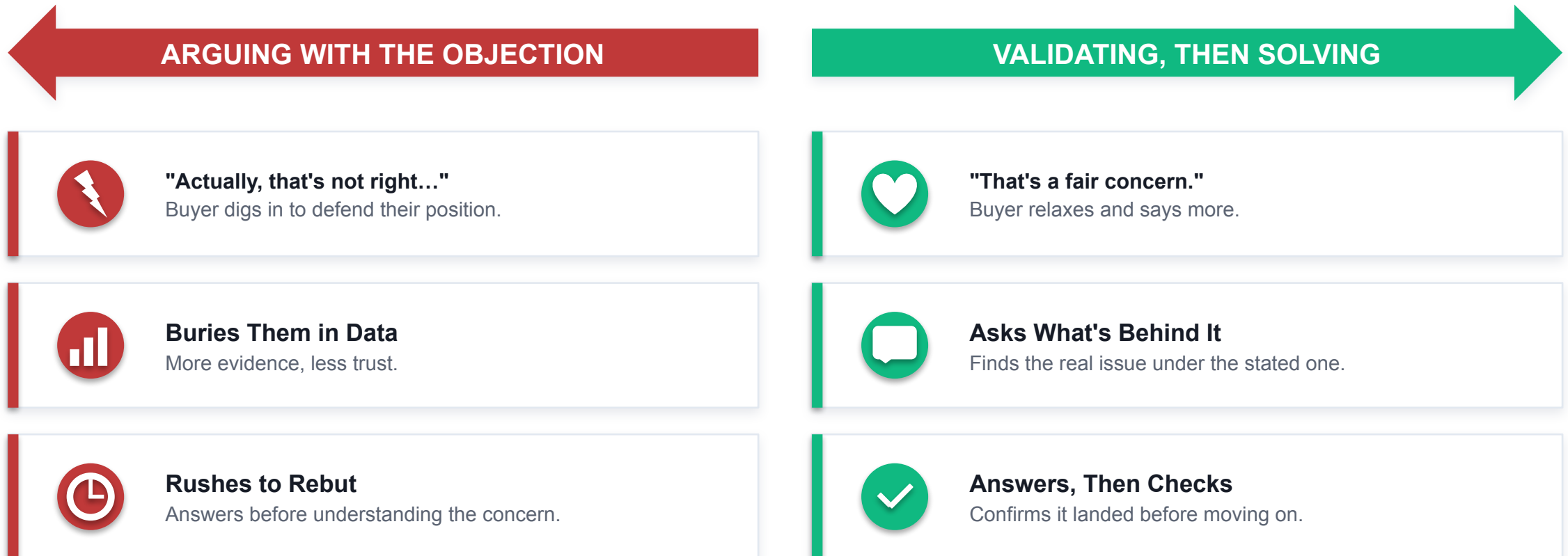
Answer & Ask — Never Go Quiet



Answering and then falling silent leaves the buyer alone with their doubt. The question is what keeps the conversation alive.

Source: Answer & Ask technique; isolation question (alexberman.com)

Arguing vs Validating



Source: empathy-driven objection handling

Feel · Felt · Found — Still Works After 50 Years

A simple three-beat structure for turning a concern into social proof.



Feel

"I understand how you feel about the switching risk."



Felt

"Sunrise Builders felt exactly the same way."



Found

"What they found was the pilot took nine days, not six weeks."

Source: Feel-Felt-Found technique, in sales use since the 1970s

LO4 · LU4 · T3

Composure Under Pressure

What is Composure Under Pressure?

The buyer's frustration is rarely about you. Your job is to stay the calmest person in the conversation.



Separate Self From Deal

Their no is about fit, not about your worth.



Buy Six Seconds

A breath before responding prevents most regrets.



Name It Internally

Labelling your own reaction reduces its intensity.

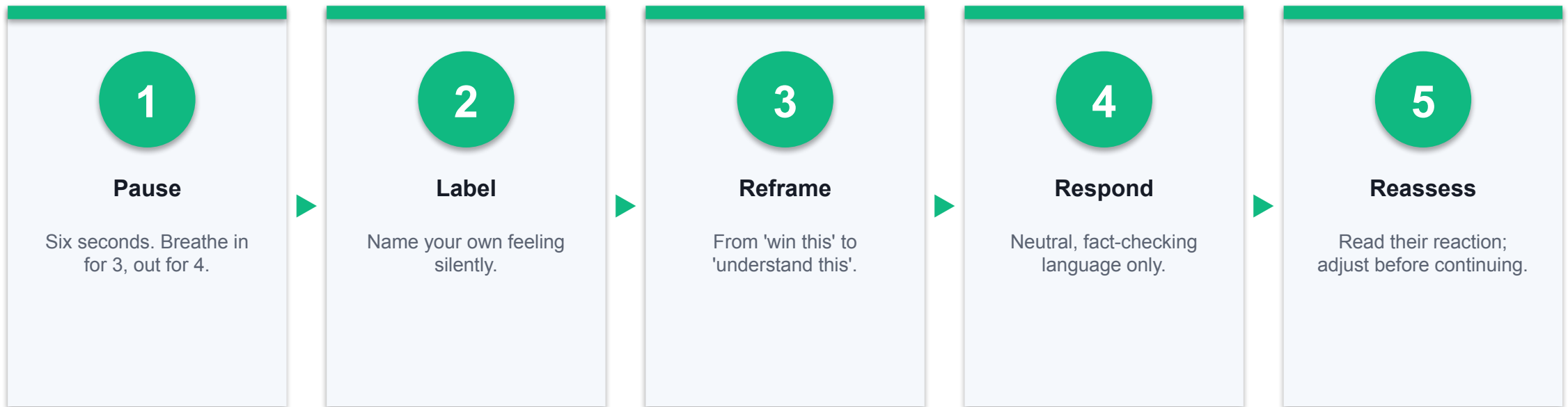


Reframe the Goal

Switch from winning the point to learning the reason.

Source: emotional-regulation practice in sales negotiation

The Five-Step Micro-Routine



Practise this on three live calls this week. It is the single most transferable skill in the entire course.

Source: five-step emotion-regulation micro-routine, EI negotiation practice

Reading the Buyer's Emotional Signals

What You Observe

- Short, clipped responses.
- An unusually long silence.
- Repeated questions about price.
- Voice rising, pace quickening.

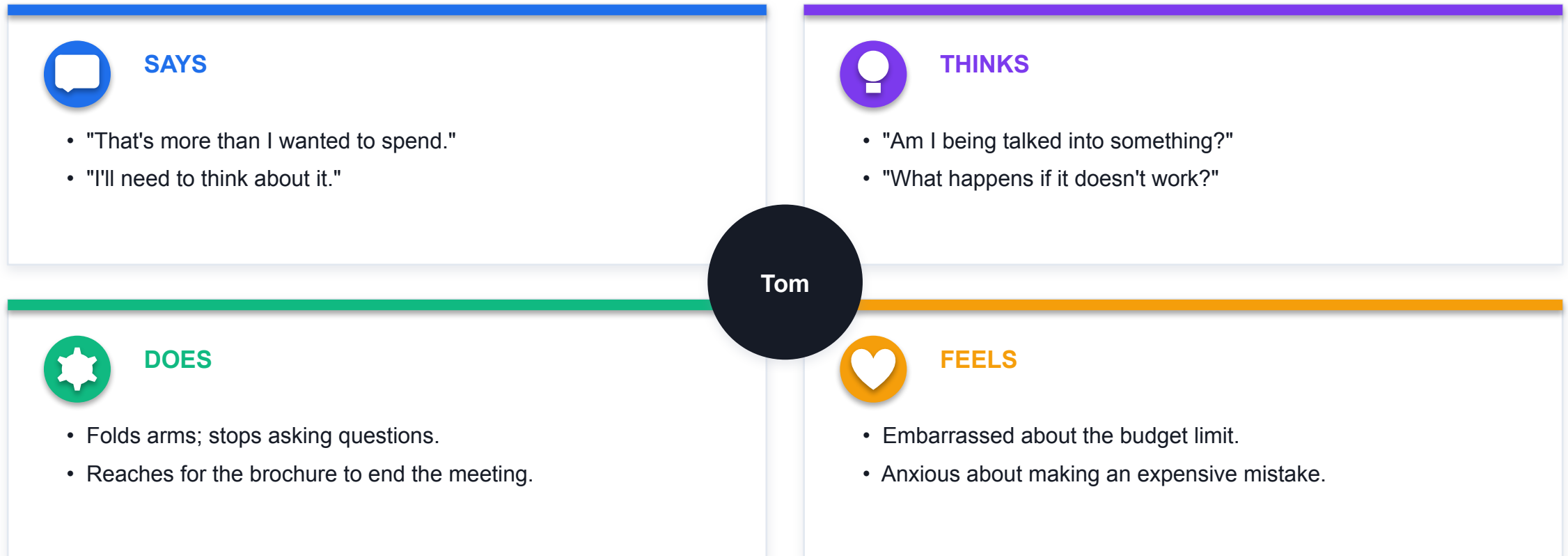
What To Do About It

- Acknowledge the time pressure; offer to be brief.
- Let it sit, then ask an open clarifying question.
- Reframe the benefit in their own metrics.
- Slow your own pace; simplify; offer concrete choices.

Source: buyer-signal / response mapping, EI negotiation practice

Empathy Map — Tom, Mid-Objection

The homeowner from today's role play, at the exact moment he says the system is too expensive.



Source: empathy-mapping practice, grounded in this course's role-play persona

LO4 · LU4 · T4

Testimonials & Social Proof

What is Testimonials & Social Proof?

You arguing your own case is the weakest evidence available. A similar customer saying it for you is the strongest.



Similarity Matters Most

Same industry, same size, same problem as theirs.



Specific Beats Glowing

A number outperforms an enthusiastic adjective.



Timing Is Everything

Deploy right after the concern, never before.

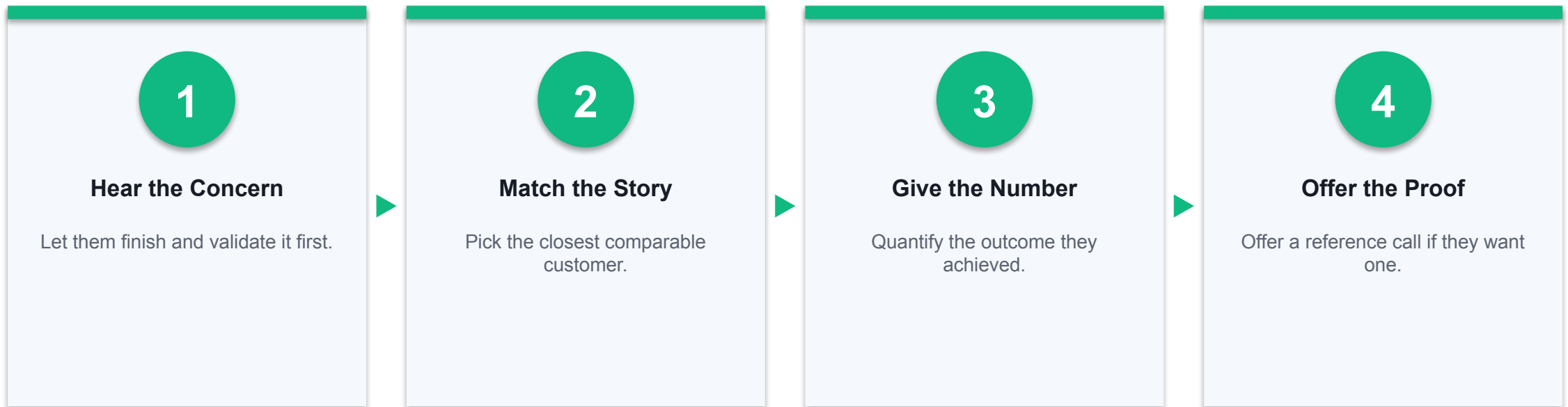


Verifiable Only

Never invent or embellish a customer story.

Source: social-proof practice; Cialdini's Social Proof principle

Deploying a Testimonial Properly



A testimonial offered before the objection is marketing. Offered right after it, it is evidence.

Source: testimonial-deployment practice

A Weak Testimonial vs A Strong One

Weak

- "Our customers absolutely love the product."
- No name, no industry, no number.
- Delivered as a slide in the standard deck.
- Unverifiable, so easy to discount.

Strong

- "Sunrise Builders cut chased status updates by 70% in nine weeks."
- Named, comparable, and measured.
- Delivered at the exact moment the doubt appeared.
- Backed by an offer to speak to them directly.

Source: social-proof quality practice

Handling a Genuine Rejection Well

How you lose determines whether you are ever invited back.



Accept Gracefully

"I appreciate you telling me straight."



Ask What Would Change It

Learn the condition that would flip the answer.



Leave the Door Open

Agree one useful touchpoint for the future.



Ask for the Referral

"Who else might have this problem?"

Source: rejection-handling and Backwards Close practice

LO4 · LU4 · T5

Sales Closure Metrics

What is Sales Closure Metrics?

'Close better' is not a plan. These are the numbers that turn a vague ambition into something a team can actually manage.



Conversion Rate

Proposals that become signed deals, by stage.



Average Deal Size

Revenue per closed deal, tracked over time.



Sales-Cycle Length

Days from first conversation to signature.

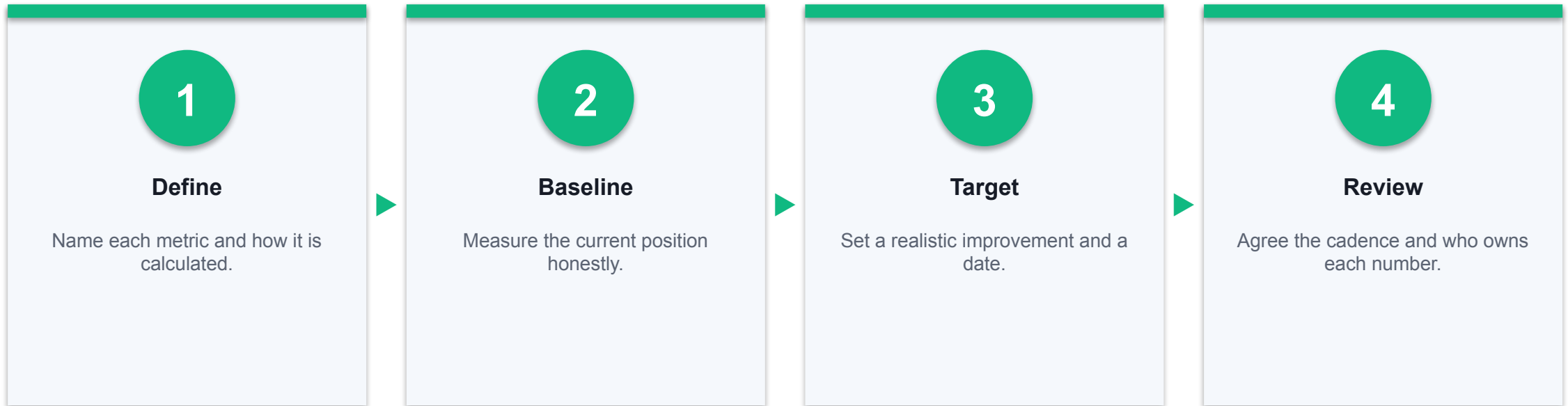


Discount Depth

Average discount given — a proxy for value selling.

Source: sales-closure metric practice (K1 / A1)

Building the Evaluation Framework

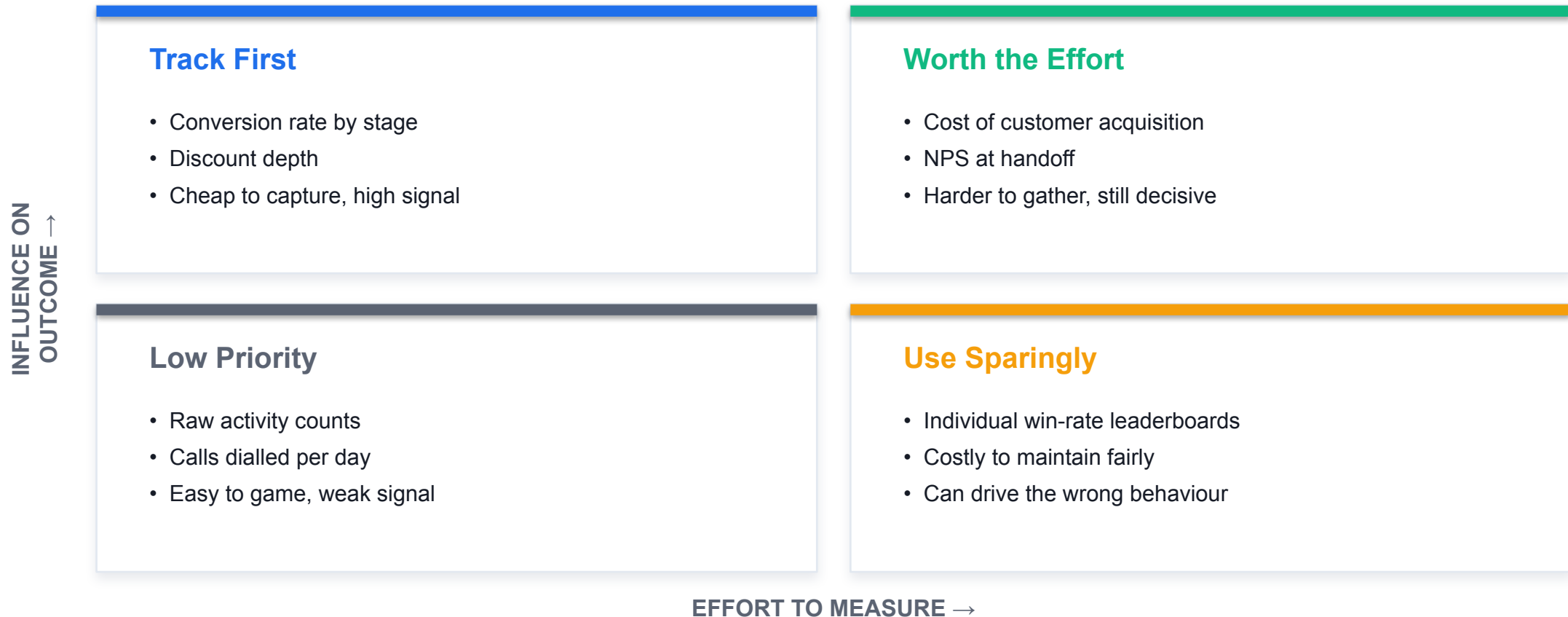


A metric with no named owner and no review date is a number on a slide, not a management tool.

Source: sales-performance management practice

Choosing Metrics That Actually Drive Behaviour

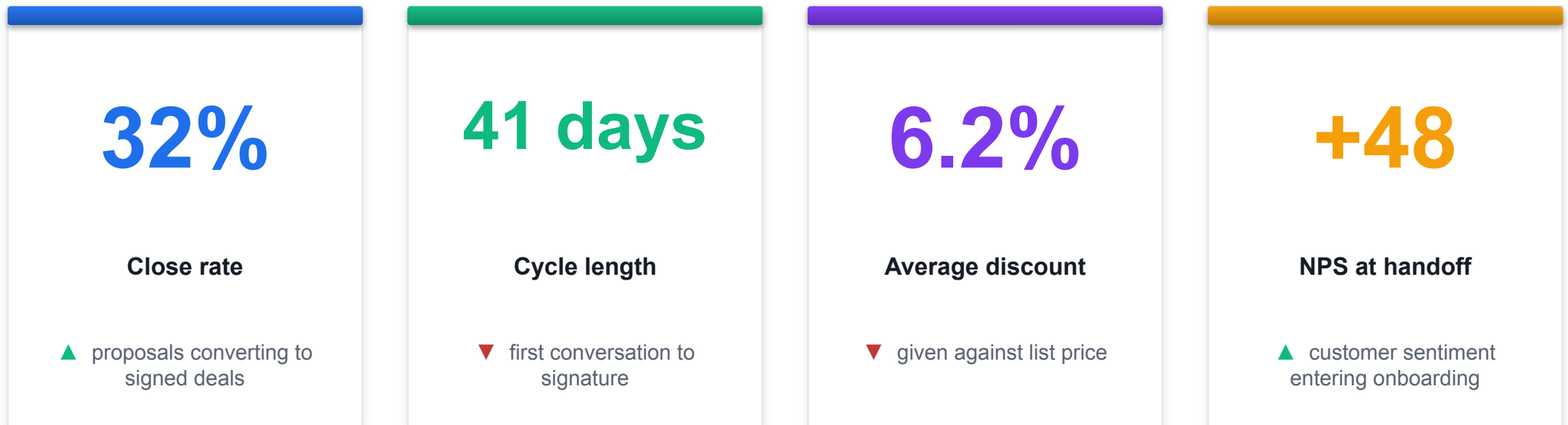
Effort to measure against influence on outcome. Start top-right, and be honest about the bottom-left.



Source: metric-selection practice for sales performance

A Sales Closure Scorecard

Illustrative quarterly scorecard — the shape your own evaluation framework should take.



Illustrative targets — a falling cycle length and a falling discount depth together are the clearest sign that value selling is working.

Source: illustrative sales-closure scorecard, performance-management practice

Role Play: Handling Objections & Rejections

ROLE PLAY

THE SITUATION

Sophie sells a high-end home security system. Tom is a homeowner in Bukit Timah whose neighbour was burgled six weeks ago. He requested the quotation himself, sat through the full home assessment, and agreed the system is exactly what he wants.

Then the price came up. Tom's first response is that it costs more than he wanted to spend — but he does not say that his real constraint is a renovation bill arriving next month, and he is slightly embarrassed about it. Later in the conversation he attempts an outright rejection to end the discomfort.

The scene requires Sophie to tell an objection from a deflection from a genuine rejection, validate before solving, use Answer & Ask and a well-matched testimonial, stay composed when Tom becomes short with her, and handle the rejection attempt in a way that keeps the relationship — and the door — open.

You'll produce: A completed Objection-Handling Observer Scorecard labelling each response as objection / deflection / rejection, with the matching technique used and the exact validating line quoted

Duration: 1 hour

Role Play: Handling Objections & Rejections

ASSIGN THE ROLES

Sophie — Sales Rep, Home Security

GOAL

Diagnose each response correctly and respond with empathy before evidence

Must resist rebutting the price objection with more features. Her task is to validate first, ask the question that surfaces the real constraint, and offer a genuine option — staged installation — rather than a discount.

Tom — Homeowner, Bukit Timah

GOAL

Protect his budget and his pride without admitting the real reason

Genuinely wants the system. Raises price as the objection, deflects when asked directly, and if pushed will attempt a flat rejection to escape the discomfort. Will reveal the renovation bill ONLY if Sophie validates him first and asks well.

Observer / Coach

GOAL

Score the diagnosis, the validation and the composure

Marks each of Tom's responses as objection, deflection or rejection, and checks whether Sophie's reply matched. Notes whether validation came before the answer, and whether Sophie stayed composed when Tom became short.

Role Play: Handling Objections & Rejections

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

- 1 Label each of Tom's three responses: objection, deflection or rejection. Did Sophie's reply match the diagnosis each time?
- 2 Where exactly did Sophie validate before solving — and was there a moment she jumped straight to the answer?
- 3 Which question finally surfaced the renovation bill? What made it safe enough for Tom to admit it?
- 4 When Tom became short and folded his arms, what did Sophie do with her own reaction? What would the five-step routine have changed?
- 5 Was the testimonial well matched to Tom, and was it deployed at the right moment?
- 6 Tom attempted an outright rejection. Did Sophie keep the door open in a way that was genuine rather than pushy?

Role Play: Handling Objections & Rejections

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- What is the cost of misdiagnosing a deflection as a rejection — and vice versa?
- How did naming Tom's feeling out loud change the temperature of the conversation?
- Which objection in your own work have you been arguing with instead of validating?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

The observer can label all three of Tom's responses correctly, quote the line where Sophie validated before answering, name the question that surfaced the real constraint, and describe how the rejection attempt was handled without either caving or pushing.

Recap — Handling Objections & Rejections

1

Objection vs Deflection vs Rejection

You can now: tell an objection, a deflection and a rejection apart and respond correctly to each.

2

The Objection-Handling Framework

You can now: apply a structured, empathy-first sequence to any objection raised.

3

Staying Composed Under Pressure

You can now: regulate your own emotional response so a hostile objection does not derail the call.

4

Testimonials & Social Proof

You can now: use evidence and social proof to convert scepticism without arguing.

5

Metrics of the Sales Closure Process

You can now: define organisational evaluation metrics that make sales closure measurable and improvable.

6

Role Play: Handling Objections & Rejections

You practised: diagnose and respond to objections, deflections and a rejection using empathy-first technique.

LU4 · WHY IT MATTERS

An objection is not a wall. It's a door that hasn't been shown how to open yet.

— Closing thought, LU4: Handling Objections & Rejections

The Empathy-Driven Closing Playbook

01

Sell Like a Human

Mindset, trust and discovery come before any technique or script (LU1).

02

Solve Before You Pitch

Educate, demonstrate and earn buy-in before ever upselling (LU2).

03

Make It Easy to Say Yes

Justify value, simplify the process, and follow up properly (LU3).

04

Turn Objections Into Trust

Answer, ask and use evidence instead of arguing (LU4).

Every technique in this course fails without empathy underneath it. Lead with the human being in front of you, and the close takes care of itself.



WRAP-UP

Course Summary & Next Steps

What You Achieved

1

Foundations of Selling

Built a confident, human, empathy-driven mindset and a real discovery skillset.

2

Selling Techniques & Problem-Solving

Ran a tailored demo and applied upselling/cross-selling with the right timing.

3

Closing the Sale

Justified price with value, used mini closes and followed up properly.

4

Handling Objections & Rejections

Told objection, deflection and rejection apart, and responded to each correctly.

Course Feedback

1

Complete the course feedback form shared by your trainer before you leave.

2

Tell us what worked and what we can improve — every response is read.

3

Your certificate of completion will be emailed to you after the course.

4

Keep the slides and Learner Guide as your reference after class.

SEE YOU AT THE NEXT ONE

Thank You!

You are now equipped to close sales with empathy-driven, people-focused selling that earns trust and drives results.